



Manage and implement small projects

D1.HGE.CL7.04

D1.HGA.CL6.11

Trainee Manual



Manage and implement small projects

D1.HGE.CL7.04

D1.HGA.CL6.11

Trainee Manual



**William
Angliss
Institute**

Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality

Project Base

William Angliss Institute of TAFE

555 La Trobe Street

Melbourne 3000 Victoria

Telephone: (03) 9606 2111

Facsimile: (03) 9670 1330

Acknowledgements

Project Director:	Wayne Crosbie
Chief Writer:	Alan Hickman
Subject Writer:	Alan Hickman
Project Manager/Editor:	Alan Maguire
DTP/Production:	Daniel Chee, Mai Vu, Kaly Quach

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on "Toolbox Development for Front Office, Food and Beverage Services and Food Production Divisions".

This publication is supported by the Australian Government's aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

Copyright: Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) 2013.

All rights reserved.

Disclaimer

Every effort has been made to ensure that this publication is free from errors or omissions. However, you should conduct your own enquiries and seek professional advice before relying on any fact, statement or matter contained in this book. The ASEAN Secretariat and William Angliss Institute of TAFE are not responsible for any injury, loss or damage as a result of material included or omitted from this course. Information in this module is current at the time of publication. Time of publication is indicated in the date stamp at the bottom of each page.

Some images appearing in this resource have been purchased from stock photography suppliers Shutterstock and iStockphoto and other third party copyright owners and as such are non-transferable and non-exclusive. Clip arts, font images and illustrations used are from the Microsoft Office Clip Art and Media Library. Some images have been provided by and are the property of William Angliss Institute.

Additional images have been sourced from Flickr and SXC and are used under Creative Commons licence: <http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/2.0/deed.en>

File name: TM_Manage_&_implement_small_projects_refined

Table of contents

Introduction to trainee manual.....	1
Unit descriptor.....	3
Assessment matrix	5
Glossary	7
Element 1: Plan project.....	9
Element 2: Administer and monitor project.....	63
Element 3: Evaluate project	93
Presentation of written work.....	109
Recommended reading.....	111
Trainee evaluation sheet.....	113
Trainee self-assessment checklist	115

Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Manage and implement small projects

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Manage and implement small projects in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HGE.CL7.04

D1.HGA.CL6.11

Nominal Hours:

100

Element 1: Plan project

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Develop the objectives and scope of the project in consultation with appropriate colleagues and customers
- 1.2 Determine and develop a resource strategy for the project
- 1.3 Evaluate the financial viability of the project through analysis of key factors
- 1.4 Plan and create an administrative structure for the project
- 1.5 Allocate project responsibilities in agreement with others, and clearly communicate responsibilities to all involved
- 1.6 Plan internal and external communications, and public relations and marketing strategies together with appropriate colleagues
- 1.7 Reach agreement on suitable project evaluation methods
- 1.8 Develop an overall project management plan and communicate plan to appropriate colleagues
- 1.9 Identify key project milestones and communicate these to persons involved

Element 2: Administer and monitor project

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Implement and monitor project in conjunction with project team members
- 2.2 Provide support and assistance to team members, as required
- 2.3 Build trust and respect within the project team
- 2.4 Assess and review progress against project goals and in consultation with project team members
- 2.5 Determine the need for additional project resources and take action accordingly
- 2.6 Monitor budget in accordance with enterprise guidelines
- 2.7 Provide regular reports on project progress to all appropriate colleagues/customers
- 2.8 Complete the project within agreed time lines

Element 3: Evaluate project

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Assess project at specified stages, using agreed evaluation methods
- 3.2 Take account of agreed goals and priorities when carrying out a project evaluation
- 3.3 Involve project team members, appropriate colleagues and customers in the project evaluation
- 3.4 Incorporate evaluation results into ongoing project management
- 3.5 Share information from project evaluation with appropriate colleagues and incorporate information into future planning
- 3.6 Report on project

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Plan project				
1.1	Develop the objectives and scope of the project in consultation with appropriate colleagues and customers	1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Determine and develop a resource strategy for the project	1.1	3, 4	2
1.3	Evaluate the financial viability of the project through analysis of key factors	1.1	5	3
1.4	Plan and create an administrative structure for the project	1.1	6, 7, 8	4
1.5	Allocate project responsibilities in agreement with others, and clearly communicate responsibilities to all involved	1.1	9, 10	5
1.6	Plan internal and external communications, and public relations and marketing strategies together with appropriate colleagues	1.1	11 – 14	6
1.7	Reach agreement on suitable project evaluation methods	1.1	15, 16	7
1.8	Develop an overall project management plan and communicate plan to appropriate colleagues	1.1	17, 18, 19	8
1.9	Identify key project milestones and communicate these to persons involved	1.1	20	9

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 2: Administer and monitor project				
2.1	Implement and monitor project in conjunction with project team members	2.1	21, 22	10
2.2	Provide support and assistance to team members, as required	2.1	23, 24	11
2.3	Build trust and respect within the project team	2.1	25	12
2.4	Assess and review progress against project goals and in consultation with project team members	2.1	26, 27	13
2.5	Determine the need for additional project resources and take action accordingly	2.1	28	14
2.6	Monitor budget in accordance with enterprise guidelines	2.1	29, 30	15
2.7	Provide regular reports on project progress to all appropriate colleagues/customers	2.1	31	16
2.8	Complete the project within agreed time lines	2.1	32, 33	17
Element 3: Evaluate project				
3.1	Assess project at specified stages, using agreed evaluation methods	3.1	34, 35	18
3.2	Take account of agreed goals and priorities when carrying out a project evaluation	3.1	36, 37	19
3.3	Involve project team members, appropriate colleagues and customers in the project evaluation	3.1	38	20
3.4	Incorporate evaluation results into ongoing project management	3.1	39, 40	21
3.5	Share information from project evaluation with appropriate colleagues and incorporate information into future planning	3.1	41, 42	22
3.6	Report on project	3.1	43	23

Glossary

Term	Explanation
360° feedback	Feedback from all points of the compass
Attendees	Those who will attend a function or event
CPA	Critical Path Analysis
CPM	Critical Path Method
C/SCS	Cost/Schedule Control System
C/SCSC	Cost/Schedule Control System Criteria
Distribution List	List of people and organisations who are to receive copies of reports
FTA	Fault-tree analysis
HR	Human Resources
IT	Information Technology
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
LCCA	Life Cycle Cost Analysis
LSA	Logistics Support Analysis
MICE	Meetings, Incentives, Conventions and Exhibitions
MIS	Management Information System
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
No blame policy	A policy which states people will not get into trouble if they tell you honestly what occurred regardless if they were at fault
PERT	Program/Project Evaluation and Review Technique
PM	Project Manager
PMS	Project Management Software

Term	Explanation
PR	Public Relations
Post mortem	Review of a project undertaken when the project has been completed
Project deliverables	Outcomes a project is expected to achieve
QA	Quality Assurance
RFP	Request for Proposal
RFT	Request for Tender
Scope of authority	The authority or permission you have to make decisions and take action on behalf of your employer without needing to consult with anyone else
Stakeholders	People or organisations with a vested interest in the project
Succession planning	Grooming and training staff to take over from someone else when the person leaves the organisation or is promoted to another position within the business
The Board	Board of Directors or Board of Management
VIP	Very Important Person
WBS	Work Breakdown Structure

Element 1: Plan project

1.1 Develop the objectives and scope of the project in consultation with appropriate colleagues and customers

Introduction

It is necessary to understand what a project is about when you undertake one.

This section provides some background context to small projects and looks at identifying the objectives and scope of the project in consultation with relevant stakeholders.

Project management

While there are no strict definitions for the terms 'project management' it can be seen as a series of activities undertaken by a person (or group of people) to achieve the stated objectives of a project while making sure the limitations and constraints that apply to the project are observed.

The central activities involved in project management can be seen as:

- Planning and preparation
- Organising and arranging
- Resource identification and acquisition
- Project implementation and administration
- Monitoring activities – before and during the project
- Project evaluation and review.



What is a project?

This is impossible to define but all projects have certain qualities:

- They are temporary in nature – they do not exist as part of the everyday, ongoing activities of the organisation
- They have a beginning; there is a start date
- They have an end date; there is a final date for completion
- They have stated goals/objectives. These specify what the project is expected to achieve: they may be called 'project deliverables'



- They have limitations, restrictions or constraints. All projects must, for example, fit within a budget, occur within a specified physical area and only involve nominated people and/or resources
- They require interaction and collaboration with others to determine and approve decisions to be made and action to be taken, to obtain relevant information and to assist in numerous ways with project management activities.

Small projects

'Small' projects are limited by one or more of the following factors:

- Duration. The length of time the project will take from 'start' to 'finish' is comparatively short. Timeframes for small projects exist traditionally within the 'one week' to 'three months' range
- Physical resources involved. Small projects generally require significantly fewer physical resources than is the case for major projects
- Human resources required. A small project can sometimes involve only you in conjunction with designated external stakeholders. Sometimes the small project may require you to be assisted by a limited number of internal staff, or the involvement of workplace staff for a nominated number of hours
- Financial resources committed. Generally speaking a small project involves less money
- Information necessary. Compared to large or major projects a small project often requires very little information from within the organisation and from outside the organisation (from external customers, suppliers, businesses, agencies or authorities)
- Complexity. Small projects are usually quite simple and straightforward.



Management of small projects

You will often be expected to also undertake your 'normal' workplace duties while managing the small project.

Major projects often have a Project Manager whereas small projects do not.

This means you will need to become quickly skilled at:

- Time management. You will need to ensure all your traditional work is completed as required and that all the requirements of the project are fulfilled
- Delegating. Most supervisors and managers who are handed project management responsibilities will need to share their normal workload by delegating it to others
- Multi-tasking. You will have to develop the ability and capacity to do numerous things at the same time.



Examples of small projects

There is no limit to what may be classified as a 'small project'.

They may relate to:

- Conferences and meetings, promotional or other events conducted on-site or at a remote venue for a client as a component of the MICE industry sector
- Introduction of new technology or systems into the workplace to increase efficiency, save money, meet marketplace competition, comply with a legislated obligation and/or satisfy identified customer demand
- Product development which can be seen as relating to:
 - The creation of a new product or the development of an upgraded product based on an existing product
 - The development of packages
 - Service enhancement including the development of service quality criteria
 - Refurbishing
- Research projects for a range of topics which may include:
 - Customer satisfaction surveys
 - Resource acquisition
 - Legislated compliance requirements
- Ongoing business projects such as taking responsibility for delivering one component of a bigger 'major' project, for example:
 - You might have responsibility for the food and beverage elements of a function but not responsibility for staffing, security, entertainment or other aspects of the event
 - You may be asked to handle the purchase of tables and chairs for a refurbished restaurant but not be involved in the planning and building stages, the decoration or the development of new menus
 - You may be asked to undertake specified market research activities if the venue has embarked on a wider project to attract a new target market.



Consulting with others

There is commonly a need when managing a small project to cooperate, collaborate and consult with others in relation to the project.

You may need to consult with:

- Other supervisors from other departments or sections
- Managers of other divisions or areas
- Owners of the business
- Staff from relevant operational departments
- The client where there is a person or organisation paying for an event or function

- Attendees at an event or function to determine their needs, wants and preferences
- Providers and suppliers. These are the businesses who sell you the goods and services needed to undertake or support the implementation of a project
- Government authorities and agencies to determine legal compliance requirements, and to solicit support and assistance with implementation of the project.



The requirement to consult with others frequently extends beyond the vital planning phase into the implementation stages of the project.

Ways to consult

The following have proved effective in engaging with staff in project work:

- Develop dedicated project teams
- Discuss the project at staff meetings, team briefings and similar
- Hold a special staff meeting (or series of meetings) with a sole focus on the project
- Involve staff who participated in other similar projects either at the venue or at other businesses where they have worked
- Invite staff to participate. Never assume staff will participate or will want to participate
- Pay staff to participate. Consult and meet during work hours as opposed to expecting staff to participate in their own time
- Thank people for participating and contributing
- Recognise and acknowledge contributions made.



Remember: consultation is *only* consultation

When you have responsibility for a small project you may have an obligation to consult with others but you retain your right to decide.

Never allow a project to get bogged down in never-ending consultation where every possible element is considered and debated over and over.

Consult by all means but be prepared to move on when 'sufficient' consultation has occurred.

You may decide:

- To use or factor in the contributions made by others where you believe these are legitimate and practicable comments which can be legally integrated into the project while still allowing the required objectives to be achieved and the necessary limitations to be met
- To ignore the input. In many cases you simply cannot implement or integrate what everyone wants to include. Best practice is to get back to the person or persons who made such contribution and explain why their suggestion cannot be incorporated into the project plan.

Project scope and objectives

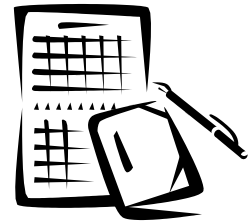
Project scope statement

A project scope statement sets out the scope of the project.

This scope refers to identifying the things (tasks, project deliverables) that have to be completed for the project to be successfully completed.

It therefore defines your responsibility for the project. If matters are not covered by the project scope (statement) then they are, quite simply, not part of the project and not your responsibility.

Great attention is paid to producing this document as it provides the basis for determining the budget required to enable the project to proceed.



Contents of a Project Scope Statement

There is no standard format for Scope Statements but they can be expected to cover:

- Justification or rationale for the project explaining why the project is taking place. This may take into account market research findings and internal demand for whatever is the focus of the project, for example:
 - Need for increased dining areas
 - Need for more room for front office
 - Need for extra external entertainment facilities
 - Need for room renovations
 - Need to respond to competition or other venues which threaten the ongoing viability of the business
 - Need to comply with a legal obligation
- Project deliverables. There can be two types of 'deliverables':
- One type relates to milestones to be achieved within the duration of the project. These are similar to KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) designed to help determine if the project is on track or not by set dates
- The second type of deliverable is the end product for the project. These are the 'things' the project is intended to achieve when it is complete
- Name of the client or delegating or funding body. This will often be the business itself because most small projects are initiated by the business on its own behalf or for its own benefit
- Where the project is commissioned by a customer, or an outside agency or client their name and contact details will be provided and they are identified as the client or delegating body
- See 'Seeking clarification from delegating authority' below



- Objectives for the project. All projects have numerous objectives and this section will set out:
 - All quantifiable outcomes the project is intended to achieve
 - The budget available
 - Relevant quality indicators specifying the intended level of quality to be achieved by activities and outcomes

A standard requirement is all objectives for the project must conform to the SMART acronym meaning they must all be:

- Specific
 - Measurable
 - Achievable
 - Realistic
 - Time-related and Trackable
- Risks identified for the project together with the level of acceptability and how to manage them
 - Project management details specifying who will have responsibility and/or the structure of the project management team (which is often you, members of the Board and co-opted people as required).



Relevant documentation

Depending on the scale and nature of the project you may also need to access, read and understand a variety of other documents associated with the project.

These *may* include:

- Contracts already entered into by the venue. These could be ongoing, pre-existing contracts (for maintenance, service, repairs, support, technology), or they could be contracts developed specifically for the project and entered into just for the project by senior management or owners

In some cases your project management responsibilities will require you to undertake initial research and investigation to provide the basis for entering into project-based contractual relationships. In other cases this type of decision will have been taken by management or the owner and your job is to work within the already determined contract



- Other agreements. It is also possible 'other arrangements' have been entered into by the business regarding the provision of services, joint venture arrangements, preferred supplier arrangements, MOUs (Memorandums of Understanding) or similar. You will be expected to function within the constraints these documents may impose
- Project brief. This is a document similar to a Project Scope Statement that may identify ancillary project matters such as:
 - Constraints, limitations and restrictions on the project. These may be non-negotiable elements for the project which simply have to be accommodated regardless of all other considerations

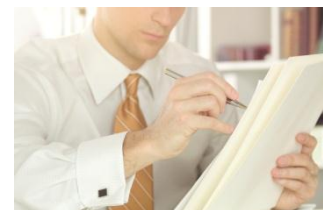
- Assumptions underpinning the rationale for the project and the thinking behind the development of the project outcomes and deliverables
 - The context for the project. This provides insight and information to assist with better locating the project into the framework and operational setting or environment of the organisation
 - Stakeholders in the project. This identifies the internal and external people or bodies with an interest in the project
 - A communication strategy for the project, identifying the internal and external stakeholders who need to be kept informed about the progress of the project, and indicating the frequency and nature of this communication
 - Relevant workplace policies. This identifies policies of the business which may impact on the project and need to be taken into account as part of the project
 - Legislated requirements stating mandatory compliance requirements, and identifying the authorities and legislation, regulations, codes and by-laws which apply
- Project management plan. You may be required to prepare the Project Plan or you may be given one already prepared. See [1.8](#) for further details
 - A range of supplementary documents tied to the specific nature of the project which, if not already contained in the above documents, may address:
 - Expected outcomes
 - Inclusions and exclusions for the project. Understanding the exact nature of these is critical to avoid 'project creep' where more and more is included in project work even though it was not originally considered, approved or funded
 - Timeframes for the project and identified stages
 - Quality standards and criteria for project deliverables
 - Project resources – see [Section 1.2](#).



The importance of these documents

For all the documents identified above, you must:

- Obtain them. Get your own copy
- Read them once, twice and possibly three times
- Understand them. Clarify everything that is not clear to you
- Know them. Commit them to memory as they form the basis of all your future action in relation to the project.



Never be shy about re-reading any of these documents throughout the course of the project.

Always consider meeting with the person or groups who produced these documents to get their input regarding interpretations and intent for every document presented to you. The true context of many documents often lies in what is revealed only when talking with those who drafted the documents.

Seeking clarification from delegating authority and/or funding body

No project should proceed until there is total clarity about what the requirements of the project are.

A Project Manager can never assume they know what is required. All proposed action must be clarified, and there is sometimes a requirement all action must receive actual verbal or written approval before it can be taken.



The 'delegating authority' will depend on what the project is.

For functions or events the delegating authority could be an individual – a private person, or someone who represents a business.

Where finance for a building, renovation or upgrading project has been received from a funding body (such as an industry body, or a government authority), this body or agency becomes the delegating authority.

In hospitality venues the Board, management or the owner is the delegating body for 99.9% of all projects (with the exception of, for example, functions).

In many ways, exactly who can be seen as the delegating authority depends on who is paying for things. The person or agency who pays is essentially the delegating authority.

Seeking clarification on 'project parameters'

Because the delegating authorities are commissioning and/or paying for the project it stands to reason that they will have a significant say in it.



The delegating authority should always be consulted whenever there is a need to discuss, determine, clarify, alter or address 'project parameters'.

Project parameters relate to anything that may constrain, limit or restrict actions in relation to executing the project. These parameters may have been established, quantified and detailed as part of the project scope or brief, or they may have only emerged after action was commenced on the project.

It is always to be expected that there will be emerging issues impacting on the parameters of any project. It is useful to bear in mind that the planning phase can only foresee and address so much. It is in the nature of projects that they always create unforeseen issues that must be taken into account.

While planning is essential, it is never a guarantee things will always go smoothly. Planning tends to simply reduce the amount of unforeseen problems.

Clarification on project parameters could include meeting with management, delegating authorities or funding bodies (or their representatives) to address the following topics:

- Clarify ambiguity in any of the documents referred to above
- Resolve uncertainty about standards and quality requirements for deliverables
- Determine sequencing of competing action and priorities
- Decide what is, and what is not, included in the project scope

- Discuss and justify the need for extra resources – see [Section 2.5](#)
- Provide insight or direction regarding the integration of this project with other projects being undertaken by the business either previously, at the same time, or being planned into the future
- Research and/or give advice regarding legislative and quality standards especially relating to compliance, safety, protection of the organisation against legal action (civil as well as criminal)
- Clarify actions related to the procurement of items necessary for project implementation. This can cover a wide variety of aspects including:
 - Consideration of preferred suppliers
 - Assurance relating to continuity of supply
 - Previous work undertaken by potential suppliers or providers
 - Need to obtain quotations
 - Need to view previous work already done by suppliers or providers.



When dealing with an external delegating authority it is possible the project is operating under a legally-binding contract which specifies suppliers or providers for certain items needing to be procured for the project.

This means you may not be free to purchase goods and services from your preferred or regular supplier. You may be contractually obliged to buy from a nominated alternate supplier.

- Clarify the project reporting requirements. These are commonly spelled out in the project brief but can be subject to change over the duration of the project especially where the project exists over an extended period. Clarification of reporting requirements can involve:
 - Adding people or bodies to the Distribution List for standard notification and reporting. It may also involve deleting people from it, or changing the mix of those to be included
 - Changing the format used for reporting as initially set out in the project brief
 - Changing the frequency of standard reporting
 - Changing the content standard reports
- Give input regarding risk analysis regarding the project. This can necessitate their involvement in:
 - Evaluating and classifying new risks emerging as the project unfolds – undertaking formal risk analysis
 - Revising and/or verifying likelihood and consequences
 - Deciding on the risk management strategy for identified risks

It must be standard practice for all projects to include consideration of safety (as it impacts on customers, staff, sub-contractors, members of the public and suppliers) as part of its risk analysis and management.

While some projects (such as functions, events) have definite timelines that cannot be altered, other projects are usually able to have extra time granted if approval of the delegating authority and/or stakeholders is obtained.

Identifying personal limits

There is a wide variety of options regarding the scope of authority you may have for a project.

It is vital to clarify exactly what applies to any project you are involved in.

It is advisable, but not always possible, to have this authority in written form so there is no confusion about what you are allowed, authorised or entitled to do in your project management role.

Scope of authority



In a hospitality context it is fair to say there is commonly an extensive 'scope of authority' given to you for small projects.

In practice this means you will usually be given additional authority to make and take action on most, if not all, of the decisions relating to the project.

This additional authority may mean you are:

- Given access to statistics, information and other internal business data you do not normally have
- Granted authority to spend money on the project on behalf of the organisation in areas you do not normally spend money in, or to a greater extent than you are normally allowed to do
- Required to attend certain meetings, for example, with management, the client, delegating authorities and other departments
- Authorised to give directions and instructions to staff who are not normally your subordinates.

This level of authority is to be expected given the nature and extent of your experience (only those with relevant experience are given this responsibility), and the need to complete the project on time.

Never assume authority goes with responsibility

It is vital you determine exactly what you are authorised to do when given project management responsibilities.

Never believe you are automatically given everything and anything you need to get the job done.

In fact, in some though relatively few cases you may be given no extra authority despite having substantial additional responsibility.

Where you believe the authority you have been given does not match the need for authority you need, you must meet with management or the delegating authority to negotiate extra necessary authority.

One of the biggest impediments to an individual successfully managing a project is to be hamstrung, not by cash or resources, but by the inability to make decisions and take action as you believe they are warranted by the project.

Reporting requirements

The Communication strategy plan (where applicable – see 1.6) and/or the Project Scope Statement will identify the reporting requirements for the project.

In this context ‘reporting’ has a very broad interpretation. Reporting embraces formal reports to management as well as communication with other stakeholders.

Report characteristics

Reports for projects should be characterised by:

- Attention to detail
- Truth and honesty – full disclosure is vital
- Producing documentation (that is, a Formal Report, an Interim Report, and a Final Report) – by the required time
- Evidence of claims and statements such as copies of quotations and invoices, photographs, claims for payment, receipts for money spent
- Comparison of actual progress against KPIs, milestones and stages for the project
- Consideration of budgets including variances, amounts expended, amounts committed, amounts remaining unspent in the budget
- Issues arising, mentioning:
 - Unexpected expenses
 - Unforeseen problems and issues and how they have been addressed
- Requests relating to need for extra resources
- Identification of instances where the project is expected to finish before expected completion date and/or where it appears the project will experience a time over-run or cannot be finished at all
- Question and Answer session to allow others to question action taken, problems encountered, quality and/or quantity of deliverables
- Need to forward reports only to those listed on a Distribution List for the project.



Frequency of reporting

You can expect to have to report regarding the project:

- On a daily basis to the Manager as part of the daily management meetings held amongst the venue management team
- At every Board or management meeting. This usually means once a month
- At every committee or sub-committee meeting convened to assist with the project. This requirement is in addition to the need to report to the Board or management
- When required by stakeholders and/or delegating authorities (with the approval of venue management)
- At nominated dates as indicated by the formalised ‘reporting requirements’ contained in the project brief or Communications Plan for the project
- For the Annual Report prepared for the organisation.

It is standard practice for there to be an increased need to report (in terms of frequency and detail) where the project is failing to achieve its milestone KPIs and/or where it is experiencing negative budget outcomes.

Tips for success in project management

The following will help you succeed when given project management responsibility within an organisation:

- Never be afraid of asking for help from the Manager, the owner or other managers or supervisors
- Identify the assistance available within the venue. This means making enquiries about the experience and expertise of Board members, supervisors, staff and those in your network of industry contacts. These people can be valuable resources
- Think before you act – planning and preparation are vital for all projects. Supervisors and managers in the hospitality industry are used to making quick decisions in normal everyday working situations but projects are different given their importance, the money involved and their potential impact. Therefore it is important to understand the same 'quick response' strategy is not to be applied when managing a project
- Wherever possible seek approval for action before taking the action. This is not always possible, but it is always a good idea to present your proposed course of action to management or a designated sub-committee (established just for the project) or Manager and obtain their approval to proceed
- Try to block out certain times on certain days to do nothing but project work. If you are able to do this it means you have a given amount of time free from other interruptions and calls on your time to spend solely on the project
- This is a good thing to do because project management demands concentration, time, and focus.



1.2 Determine and develop a resource strategy for the project

Introduction

All projects require you to acquire and apply certain resources.

This section identifies the role and possible contents of a resource strategy and describes generic resources which may be required.

Role of the resource strategy

A resource strategy is a plan on how you intend achieving one or more of the following (depending on the project, and the type of resource being considered):

- Obtaining the necessary resources required to undertake the project you are managing
- Developing the resources to ensure they allow you to achieve the objectives of the project and comply with applicable requirements and/or constraints

- Maintaining the resources so they remain effective and efficient and their useful life is extended
- Using and managing resources for optimal outcomes.

The resource strategy (also known as a 'resources strategy') for a small project may:

- Be prepared in written form as a formal or semi-formal plan
- Exist only in your mind as a result of mentally considering the resources required and how you may acquire them.

Resources required

The specific resources required for each small project will obviously vary depending on the type and scope of the project and the objectives which have to be achieved.

This said, resources can be classified as:

- Human resources. This relates to the staff or personnel required for a project. Consideration may be given to:
 - The use or blend of permanent, part-time and casual employees
 - Including external providers or suppliers such as contractors
 - The experience and expertise the individuals or organisations need to have in relation to the project
 - Hours to be worked and paid for from the project budget
- Physical resources relating to machinery, equipment, utensils and other material assets required to:
 - Plan and prepare for the project such as tools of the trade, computers, software and hardware to enable planning and project management
 - Implement the project such as the requirements identified as 'deliverables' in the project scope or brief
 - Support the work of others connected with planning and implementing the project
- Financial resources. This is the money available to enable payment for all project-related requirements which can include:
 - Paying staff
 - Engaging external consultants and contractors
 - Purchasing the physical assets and resources required
- Information. This is an often overlooked resource for projects but nonetheless an extremely critical element both for planning and project implementation. It relates to a variety of usually non-negotiable factors impacting on the project such as:
 - Internal policies and procedures which must be accommodated



- Dates, times and numbers/statistics relating to the project, for example:
 - Days and date of a function
 - Numbers attending the function or event
 - Knowledge held by management or other stakeholders which you need to know in order to properly plan and execute the project.

Major projects may develop a separate resources strategy for each of the resource classifications identified above.

Contents of a resource strategy

The contents of your resource strategy will vary depending on the type of resource being considered.

In addition to what has been presented above, your resource strategies may address the points as listed for each of the required resource groups.

For human resources

The HR strategy may address:

- Selecting internal staff to participate in the project
- Providing relevant staff training as required
- Using external staff recruitment agencies to source staff
- Re-allocating work so required staff are free to engage with the project
- Backfilling staff who are required to work on the project.



For physical resources

The physical resources strategy may address:

- Determining specifications and operating requirements for each item to reflect project requirements
- Identifying possible providers or suppliers
- Trialling materials and services
- Arranging for quotations and negotiating contracts
- Comparing options for acquiring assets such as:
 - Purchasing
 - Leasing
 - Rental
- Undertaking a cost-benefit analysis for items which are significant in terms of their purchase price (see [Section 1.3](#) for more detail)
- Considering alternative acquisition options such as:
 - Borrowing items from other venues
 - Asking other organisations in the chain for a loan of items

- Asking providers or suppliers to donate items
- Joint purchasing with other businesses
- Arranging installation, commissioning and regular maintenance and servicing of equipment and systems including staff training as and if required relating to these new items
- Identifying disposal arrangements for 'old' items being replaced as well as potential re-selling or on-selling arrangements when new items have reached the end of their useful life.

For financial resources

The financial strategy may address:

- Seeking a formal budget from management
- Asking providers or suppliers for a contribution
- Seeking subsidies or grants from government agencies, industry bodies or joint venture partners
- Insisting on a purchasing option which brings a saving or other benefit to the business such as:
 - Trade, volume or early payment discounts
 - Deferred payment or extended terms of trade
 - Inclusion of a free item or service or 'bonus' into the deal
- Allocation of monies from the sale of 'old' equipment to specific revenue lines or budget lines.



For information

The information strategy may address:

- Identifying and reviewing existing documents
- Speaking with others who have previous relevant experience
- Scheduling meetings with stakeholders
- Specifying actions to ensure information remains private and confidential
- Requirements for sharing and distributing information to stakeholders.

1.3 Evaluate the financial viability of the project through analysis of key factors

Introduction

Where a project is being proposed by an outside client or delegating authority there is a need to determine the viability of the project before deciding to accept the project and prior to commencing the project.

This section considers a range of factors involved in determining the viability for an external project, looks at financial viability as it relates to internal projects and discusses project-related budget requirements.

The difference between internal and external projects

Internal projects

When you are required to undertake a project imposed by the organisation this is an internal project.

Where you are directed to manage such a project the following normally applies:

- Management have decided the project must be undertaken. It will not be up to you to determine whether or not it should go ahead
- There is no need to engage in a financial viability analysis of the project; management will have already done this.

External projects

Where you are being asked by a customer or outside business or organisation to, for example, conduct an event or function on a fee-for-service basis this is an external project.

For external projects you will be expected to conduct the project in accordance with venue requirements relating to viability. Briefly stated, each external project is expected to show 'the required profit' as determined by the venue.



Essentially, the 'viability' of the project means conducting the event or function so it returns the required level of profit to the venue, subject to certain other imperatives which may apply from time to time (see below).

'Certain other imperatives'

In some cases (relatively few), your employer may direct you to conduct an event or function so it generates *less* than the usual revenue and/or so it returns *less* than the standard profit.

The circumstances may occur when:

- The client is deemed to be a VIP customer and management wishes to demonstrate the value they hold the customer in
- There is a cash flow crisis – see below '[Evaluating financial viability](#)'
- The venue is experiencing very low occupancy and/or low levels of trade and they wish to stimulate activity to help underpin the viability of the entire organisation
- The project is an especially prestigious one and management wants to make sure it is conducted at the venue so the business obtains publicity, prestige and market. Positioning from conducting the event.

Evaluating financial viability

Evaluating the financial viability of the project may require you to determine:

- The availability of short and/or long-term funding for the project which can involve:
 - Establishing whether the required amount of money is available or not
 - Identifying sources of finance

- The cost of borrowing funds to enable the project to be implemented which may require you to:
 - Find out interest rates
 - Calculate payments required
 - Identify dates for repayments
- Internal cash flow situation of the venue which will indicate whether or not management are desperate for cash
- Market feasibility which asks you to decide whether or not the client or the project is suitable to your business in terms of matters such as the reputation of the client, and whether or not they align with the markets your organisation is catering to
- Level of financial risk involved which asks you to calculate the possible loss to your organisation against a number of potential eventualities such as:
 - Failure by the client to settle their account once the project or event has been finalised
 - The event failing to attract the numbers and revenue anticipated
 - Risks applicable to the project or function which may include adverse weather, other functions and events being operated by other venues at the same time and other risks identified by a formal risk management process (involving risk identification, risk analysis and risk control)
- The results of relevant cost-benefit analyses – see below
- The impact of the project on other aspects of the business which may include consideration of how the project or event will impact:
 - Other customers and guests using the venue
 - Service levels provided to others
 - Occupancy levels and the resultant demand for staff
 - The potential to optimize revenue and/or profit. For example, the project or event may increase revenue but not optimize profit if all the rooms are sold at a low discount rate necessary to 'win the business'
 - Need for maintenance, service and repairs to the venue
 - Requirement for extra staff and/or extra hours for staff.



Key factors to consider

As part of the process in determining the viability of a project you should take the time and make the effort to consider the following key factors.

Consideration in this context requires you to obtain or develop answers to a series of questions such as those listed below.

Availability and capacity of resources

- Do you have sufficient human resources to undertake the project?
- Is there a need to train staff to achieve the required outcomes for the project and, if so, what is involved in terms of time and money in doing this?

- If you do not have the required physical resources, can they be obtained from elsewhere and if so, what is the cost?
- Are the available physical resources suitable for the specific requirements of the project and are they serviced, safe and ready to use? If not, what is involved in making these existing resources fit to use?
- Do the resources you have meet all legal compliance requirements?
- Are the available resources sufficient in number to meet expected demand for the project?
- Is the venue appropriate for conducting the required event or function? If not, what changes have to be made to ensure the venue is suitable?
- Is there a need for the resources of the venue to integrate with resources being brought or used by those attending?

Budget

- How much money is available?
- When is it available?
- How do you access it?
- What authority do you need in order to spend it?
- Can you obtain extra funding if needed?
- Where will the extra funding come from?
- Can you transfer money from one budget or budget line to another if needed?



Contractual obligations and penalties

- What promises have been made to the client about resources and performance of the venue (in terms of products and service delivery)?
- Which promises are legally-binding and/or non-negotiable?
- Do the resources proposed and/or available align with promises made to the client regarding their performance, quality and other relevant factors?
- What legal action might the client take for failure to meet performance standards or criteria in the contract which applies to the event?
- What financial penalties (such as refunds and/or damages awarded if the venue is sued), and other penalties (such as a court injunction to perform the event again or to issue a public apology) might flow if the agreed contract is not discharged in accordance with all relevant terms and conditions?

Cost-benefit analysis

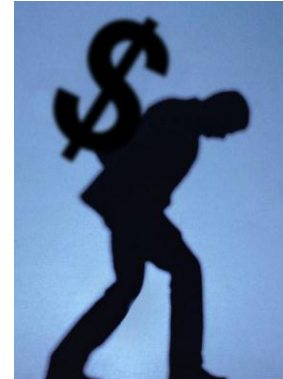
A cost-benefit analysis is a common requirement in many organisations for all expenditure over a stated amount.

Smaller, less expensive items or services are not usually subject to a cost-benefit analysis.

The cost-benefit analysis considers the costs and related benefits associated with making a nominated purchase and allows a mechanism whereby various alternatives can be compared against each other with a view to identifying the single most beneficial option for the business.

Factors considered as part of the cost-benefit analysis may include:

- Purchase price
- Trade-in or revenue obtained from selling 'old' items
- Benefits, savings and efficiencies gained
- Ongoing cost of service, repairs and maintenance
- Opportunity costs
- Expected life of the item
- Productivity.



The budget

The majority of projects are budget-based. There will normally be a limit on how much can be spent (or otherwise invested – such as time, effort, venue resources) to achieve the stated project deliverables.

The amount of money available for a project may have been:

- Set by the client funding body and/or the delegating authority. For example, the client may have a budget of 50,000 for their function, or the authority issuing the grant money may cap its funding to 75,000 for each project
- Determined by the venue. This is where management prescribes a maximum amount that can be spent on the project to achieve the outcomes identified in the Project Scope and/or Plans.

Budget set by the client

Where the client sets the budget for a project your role is to:

- Deliver the goods and services as required within the budget limitations. Attention needs to be paid to ensuring expected service standards while still returning the venue an acceptable level of profit.

Note: some clients (especially valued, regular and VIP customers) have unrealistic expectations or make unreasonable demands on your venue that they would not make on another venue. This may be because they believe your property is obliged to provide them with a better deal given their value to the business

- Meet with the client and discuss their expectations, needs, wants and preferences. Avoid making promises which create unrealistic, unprofitable and/or unachievable deliverables in terms of timing, quantities, types of food and beverages to be provided, staff numbers, rooms or areas to be used, complimentary items to be provided
- Negotiate extra payment. This is a core requirement for many projects. You have to be prepared to justify why extra money is needed to provide a function to meet client expectations. Rarely is there an open cheque book for functions but you must make

sure the client knows there is the potential for them to be charged extra if they use extra or demand more

- Obtain agreement in written form (such as a function contract) detailing what is being provided. This is vital to avoid confusion and disappointment about what is to be supplied (menu, drinks, entertainment), and also serves as the legally binding document compelling the client to pay
- Obtain payment including, for example, an initial deposit in accordance with venue requirements, progress payments (where applicable) and final payment.

Budget from a funding body

Where money is received from a government or industry body (such as in the form of a grant or subsidy) standard requirements are:



- The venue may be required to match the grant money in some way. A 'one for one' requirement is common: you need to check this prior to accepting any grant to make sure management is prepared to commit the required funds
- There are always requirements attached to the money. These are the 'strings attached' and can require you to:
 - Spend money by a certain date
 - Spend the money on a specified 'thing' or from items on a specified list of options
 - Spend the money with a specified supplier, for example, from a list of preferred suppliers or sponsors or with 'local' ('domestic') businesses
- Specified monitoring, reporting, record keeping and management requirements will apply
- Any unused money must be returned.

Budgets for venue-initiated project

Budgets for projects initiated and paid for by the venue will:

- Be developed by the venue – that is, the budget may be set as a result of discussions and negotiations involving:
 - The Board – and/or relevant Committees and/or sub-committees
 - Managers and owner/s
 - External professionals such as those with expertise in accountancy, financial planning, and taxation
 - You as the Project Manager (PM) or person responsible for the project. Your input about what might be required can be factored into their thinking (see below [Your role in budget preparation](#))
- Need to be formally approved by designated persons within the business
- Appear as a separate budget specifically for the project with its own budget code.

Your role in budget preparation

As PM or person responsible for the project your responsibilities in relation to assisting in the preparation of the budget for a project may involve:

- Attending budget or financial meetings convened by management or relevant Committees or Sub-committees
- Contributing relevant input from your knowledge and experience as it relates to the focus of the project including researching data from previous similar projects conducted at the venue
- Estimating costs based on experience, current quotations, estimations: see below 'Estimating costs'
- Determining availability of contractors, consultants and suppliers including calculating how 'lead time' may impact on costs. For example, you will always pay a premium where the project is urgent and conversely, where you prepared to wait a while, providers will usually accept a lower price for the goods and services they supply
- Providing source material and information to others for their consideration as part of the budget planning process. This will relate to the provision of a quite diverse range of topics such as:
 - Cost prices obtained from third-party providers
 - Copies of information brochures
 - Samples of goods
 - Background support materials (such as recommendations from others, results of independent research)
 - Letters of support and recommendation from others
- Obtaining quotations. It is standard procedure to obtain multiple quotations for 'significant' items and expenditures
- Most venues require three quotations
- Developing a list of preferred providers based on your personal experience, existing preferred suppliers used by the venue, and input from industry contacts who have used these businesses and recommend them
- Determining labour costs for project sub-sets where in-house staff are to be used. This involves determining:
 - The hours to be worked
 - Number of staff required including backfilling requirements, if applicable
 - Using correct pay scales to calculate full labour costs (that is, ensuring calculations factor in all applicable on-costs which may include holiday pay, penalties, sick pay, higher duties allowances)
- Ensuring all costs are identified and addressed. This is difficult to do for a 'new' project of the type never before undertaken by the venue. A brainstorming session with other supervisors and/or staff to identify costs, reference to previous project documentation (budgets, invoices), use of industry contacts and/or use of an external professional are ways to identify all costs. Where Work Breakdown Structures (see Section 1.8) have been developed this will help determine cost types



- Providing feedback to management on input and information provided to you by eligible stakeholders such as customers, previous personnel at the venue who have PM experience, executives from industry associations, inspectors from government authorities
- Providing feedback to management regarding the relationship between 'quality' and costs. In the same way there is a link between 'time' and cost, so too is there normally a link between quality and cost. You get what you pay for
- Decreasing expense generally results in:
 - A reduction in quality of products
 - A reduction in service standards
 - An extension of time required to complete the project work
- Determining the possible impacts of delays to the project in terms of (as applicable):
 - Increased overheads
 - Finance costs
 - Penalties provided for under contractual agreements
 - Service delivery to guests and customers
 - Revenue
- Identifying amount and timing of payments required for the project. This can have major implications for funding of the project and alignment of contractual arrangements with projected venue cash-flow. Payments may relate to:
 - Deposits payable to builders to commence work
 - Progress payments throughout the project at nominated times or stages
 - Final payment on completion or sign-off of work
- Evaluating or reviewing pertinent elements of applicable contracts such as:
 - Terms of trade
 - Guaranties
 - Warranties
 - Terms and conditions in contracts
 - Penalty clauses and penalties.



Taking costs into consideration

A critical aspect of determining the budget for any project is to ensure all costs have been taken into account.

Depending on the project type you may need to consider the following:

- Labour, including (as appropriate):
 - Recruitment and selection costs associated with developing necessary project team members and operational and support staff
 - Wages and remuneration – for the duration of the project – including all relevant aspects of the project which can be expected to include:
 - Planning and preparation time

- Set-up time
- Backfilling
- Attendance at meetings
- Project implementation
- Project finalisation
- Standard on-costs
- Incentives and rewards (where appropriate or applicable to staff involved in the project)
- Staff training and development
- External professional bodies and businesses to be used as project providers, suppliers, builders, security, entertainment, risk assessors, consultants. This includes payment for advice, payment for contracted work to be done, payment for goods and services to be provided
- General overheads directly associated with the project
- Preparation and planning activities such as visits to other sites to view facilities, meet with other Project Managers, meet with suppliers, meet with clients and undertake project research
- Technical and other support required for the project. This can include:
 - IT support
 - Support from external event managers for entertainment and bands, sound and lighting, and firework displays
 - Legal advice
 - Financial expertise
 - Procurement expertise
- Administration support – see ‘Secretariat’ next section
- Physical resources. This can include the food and beverages for a function, as well as plant and equipment, machinery, furniture, fixtures and fittings for any other project
- If the project was to refurbish a dining area the physical resources would reflect this specific need and be fundamentally different to the resources required if the project was to refurbish the guest rooms, the kitchen or the lobby
- Compliance requirements. Specifically this entails meeting legally imposed compliance requirements which may relate to technology, licensing, certification and safety. Special attention must be paid to ensuring all project staff have current certification to permit them to undertake nominated activities as imposed by the requirements of relevant legislation
- Contingencies. An amount is commonly included to cover the possibility of contingencies actually occurring
- Profit and/or revenue. Where the project is intended to generate profit or revenue for the venue separate figures for these must be included as part of the cost. For example the refurbishment of a restaurant or guest rooms may generate revenue through selling the old tables, chairs and beds. A figure estimating the money this is expected to generate should be included.



See <http://www.brighthub.com/office/project-management/articles/54894.aspx>.

Estimating costs

Estimates of cost to be included in a budget are rarely little more than educated guesses.

Every project, regardless of the planning undertaken, is subject to cost increases.

Even situations where a fixed price contract is signed with a supplier can be subject to increases in terms of penalties or additional work required that was not specified in the initial contract.

It has been found on the basis of experience that any estimation of cost for a project budget should be subject to a 10% - 25% loading or variance to cater for 'contingencies'; price rises, unexpected issues arising, delays and so forth.

The higher your level of confidence in the cost estimate, the lower the variance or loading should be, but it should never be zero.

1.4 Plan and create an administrative structure for the project

Introduction

Where the scope and nature demands, it is necessary and advisable to create an administrative structure for the project.

This section examines the need for an administrative structure and proposes elements for such a structure.

Identifying need for administrative structure

All major projects should have an administrative structure.

Many or most *small* projects do not require such a structure; the administrative structure is often 'you'.

You may of course liaise and consult with others as the need arises but there is often no formal structure to what takes place or to the relationship between you and the other parties.



The need for an administrative structure can be identified as a result of one or more of the following:

- Directive from management for there to be such a structure
- Pre-requisite requirement from a funding body for an administrative structure to be established to oversee and monitor the project
- Your experience – the need you see for a formal structure and a formal support structure
- Willingness of others to be part of the project
- Need to align with standing internal protocols, policies and procedures.

Benefits of an administrative structure

Planning and creating an administrative structure for a project brings with it the following potential benefits:

- A committed and dedicated source of support and advice
- A sounding board for your thoughts and proposals
- Ready access to assistance
- An established body of people to whom tasks and responsibilities may be delegated
- A formal reporting framework
- A hierarchical structure for decision making
- The ability to allocate project-related responsibilities and tasks to nominated persons or bodies.

Composition and roles/responsibilities

The administrative structure for the project may relate to the people or bodies listed below and the work they may be expected to undertake is listed for each.

An administrative structure for a project is similar to the organisational chart which may exist for the business. It contains positions with roles and responsibilities attached to each, and the layout of the structure indicates the reporting requirements and lines of authority.

Management

A suitable management (or owner) representative should always be part of an administrative structure so they can:

- Gain first-hand experience of the management of the project and your activities in managing it
- Promptly authorise action which needs to be taken outside your specified scope of authority
- Provide extra information and insight to the project as the need for them to do so arises
- Use their authority to influence others both within the organisation and external to it.



Secretariat

A 'secretariat' provides administrative support for the project.

The secretariat is often existing 'office staff' who take on extra project-related duties.

They will be required to undertake project-related tasks such as:

- General office work
- Typing – letters, reports, emails, requests for quotations, RFTs (Requests for Tenders), RFPs (Requests for Proposals), agendas for meetings, minutes of meetings
- Filing
- Photocopying

- Making telephone calls
- Scheduling meetings, notifying people of meetings, distributing required information prior to meetings, preparing rooms and venues for meetings and taking minutes of meetings
- Maintaining documentation
- Facilitating communications
- Processing payments and paperwork.

Consultants

Consultants are businesses external to the business who provide specialist advice, suggestions and recommendations.

They are paid an hourly rate or an agreed sum for their participation and contributions to the project.

Their advice maybe provided:

- Face to face – to you personally
- At project meetings
- Over the telephone
- Online.



The type of consultants required will depend on the nature of the project, for instance:

- Interior designer – where rooms are being decorated or refurbished
- Commercial catering consultants – for kitchen upgrades and renovations
- Safety consultants – for a special event e.g. a pyrotechnics display
- Language and diversity or cross-cultural experts – where a project involves people from a variety of different language, social, economic, religious or other backgrounds.

Contractors and suppliers

These are the businesses who will provide the goods and services which are at the heart of the project.

They may range from architects and builders through to carpet and paint suppliers to those who sell tables, chairs and the flowers to decorate the rooms.

Generally the following applies:

- A pre-selection occurs. For example you identify all the businesses who may be able to provide a certain product or service and then you determine which **one** will be part of the administrative structure. It is not usual for there to be two businesses representing the one type of product or service
- The organisation is required to keep the information they learn while participating in the project 'confidential'. They may be required to sign a 'confidentiality agreement' to this extent
- The goods and/or services they are expected to advise on and provide are specified and quantified
- Sample products and services are evaluated and assessed
- Quotations are obtained – valid for three months
- The participation expected of them is stipulated, for example:

- To attend XYZ meetings
 - To work cooperatively with nominated other contractors, suppliers and/or government agencies
 - To provide items which are 'fit for task'. This means they are safe, reliable, compliant with all relevant legislation and match any samples provided for inspection as part of the decision-making process about what items to purchase
 - To be available to provide telephone and on-line support at all times
- A decision on which supplier is made based on quotations, quality, and responses to other criteria.



Groups

The administrative structure may feature the use of one or more types of 'groups' which may be called:

- Advisory groups
- Reference groups
- Consultative groups.

These groups are not a necessary part of the administrative structure for *all* small projects but are beneficial in some instances, especially in situations where it is important to:

- Liaise with others – especially those external to the organisation
- Demonstrate consultation with others
- Allow others to make input
- Capture a wide range of thoughts and opinions
- Generate 360° feedback
- Encourage others to buy-in to the project and accept it.

Steering committee

A steering committee is also not a common part of most small projects.

A steering committee comprises representatives from the groups identified above and its role is to help 'steer' the project to a successful conclusion.

It does this by:

- Providing oversight of the project
- Reviewing the progress of the project against approved plans and targets
- Giving you guidance on all manner of topics which may arise as part of your management for the project. For example you may turn to the steering committee (or members of it) for advice and direction in relation to areas in which the committee members have considerable experience and acknowledged expertise in areas such as:
 - Company rules, requirements, policies, procedures and protocols
 - Legal issues

- Industrial relations
- Finance and budget
- Acquisitions
- Marketing.

Depending on how the role of the steering committee is developed or interpreted by your employer, it may have:

- An advisory role only
- Total control over the project – meaning it has the capacity and authority to take over the project from you if it believes this is necessary for whatever reason.



1.5 Allocate project responsibilities in agreement with others, and clearly communicate responsibilities to all involved

Introduction

The identified responsibilities for any project need to be allocated to the relevant persons and/or businesses so the project will achieve the required outcomes and objectives.

This section provides direction on how to allocate these responsibilities, highlights ways to communicate those responsibilities and introduces project management tools.

Please note: given the wide range of projects which may be undertaken this section does not try to identify the specific responsibilities which may need to be allocated.

Previous notes (and those which follow) indicate the type and variety of responsibilities which may need to be allocated.

Basis for allocating project responsibilities

The basis for allocating project responsibilities relates to a *combination of factors* each of which can be expected to be unique for each the various small projects you manage.

These factors are:

- The composition of your administrative structure and the expertise and experience which is available from this source
- The people who comprise your project team. In most cases these are your main support structure as they are usually **solely** dedicated to the project where other support structures (including those in your administrative structure) will contain people whose time is shared between you, your project and many other obligations
- The plans and strategies which have been developed for the specific project – see Section 1.6 and 1.8
- Known strengths and weaknesses of those available to you including their previous experience and demonstrated capacity to perform and achieve outcomes
- Staff who have indicated to you they wish to be involved and want to develop knowledge and experience in the area of project management or in the field to which the project applies

- Direction given to you by superordinates who may order you to involve certain people or organisations, or may tell you to involve certain people in nominated activities
- Your objective of developing a certain staff member to take over your position (in terms of succession planning) when you move on, or to increase the capacity for small project management within the business by multi-skilling staff who may become PMs in their own right or may serve as your deputy or assistant
- Requests from delegating bodies, clients or funding bodies that certain people within the organisation are included in the project to undertake specified roles.

Communicating the responsibilities

Basic requirements

The standard pre-requisites which need to be established before communicating responsibilities for project work to others include:

- Preferred communication method for individuals – how people prefer to receive their information. Not all preferences will be able to be catered for
- Formats and content of communications – determining in your own mind the sort of information which might be contained in different types of communications
- Distribution List – identifying those who will receive communications, for each communication type.



Facilitating clear communication

To optimise clear communication with others you should:

- Plan the communication – work out what you want to say
- Write and speak succinctly – avoid unnecessary words
- Use only words and terms known to the recipients – if you need to use a new word or term then make sure you explain it
- Only communicate when you have something to say – avoid communicating when you have nothing to say
- Allocate time for the communication – do not rush it
- Be prepared to explain what you have said – let others know you are available to provide explanations or other clarification
- Set up a system so you know people have received the communications you have sent them
- Avoid terms or words which are offensive, disrespectful or discriminatory in any way.

Methods of communication

The following will enable effective communication of project-related responsibilities:

- Scheduled, one on one, face to face exchanges which is arguably the best method to use but it very time-consuming

- Scheduled, group meetings which save time but may stifle discussion of points which need to be discussed
- Telephone communication
- Email
- Memoranda.



Project Management tools

There are a range of useful project management tools available to help effectively manage projects.

Not all tools are used for every project. Personal preference and experience regarding these tools, and the type and size of the project are the main determinants in what will be used.

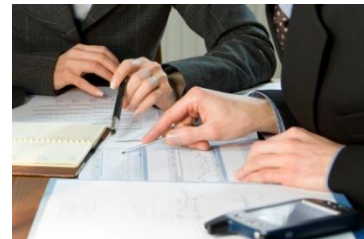
Small projects may not use any project management tools at all so this section very much seeks to just raise awareness of options available in this regard.

Where project management tools need to be obtained, the cost of purchase (for example, of project management software) must be factored into the project budget unless the software or other support materials already exists in the business.

Use of project management tools

Project management tools can be used to:

- Plan the project
- Manage and monitor the project
- Sequence project activities/work
- Control the budget
- Evaluate the project.



Cost/Schedule Control System (C/SCS)

C/SCS is a set of criteria specified by the client or funding body for a project.

The criteria stipulate requirements for both reporting the progress of the project, and recording and presenting project-related financial information.

This tool is sometimes referred to as C/SCSC (Cost/Schedule Control System Criteria).

These criteria also define financial and other terms used in relation to the project.

For more information see:

- http://www.hyperhot.com/pm_cscs.htm
- <http://www.defence.gov.au/dmo/esd/evm/DefAust5655.pdf>.



Critical Path Method (CPM)

Also known as Critical Path Analysis (CPA) this tool enables planning and management of complex projects.

CPA generally uses a linear approach, linking activities to time and dates and is extremely effective in developing a logical and effective sequence of activities and events for a project, and identifying instances where there is an overlap of activities or where similar activities coincide.

For more information see:

- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Critical_path_method
- <http://www.netmba.com/operations/project/cpm/>
- <http://hadm.sph.sc.edu/courses/j716/cpm/cpm.html>.

Gantt charts

A Gantt chart is a widely-known management tool (in effect a series of bar charts) that helps manage and plan an activity that is comprised of a series of sub-activities.

The graphical representation of activities related to required completion date helps identify what needs to be done when, and assists greatly in scheduling of activities (which can also ensure scheduling cash flow to ensure payments for activities can be made).



The reduction of a project or activity to its components sub-parts allows you to clearly identify the lead times involved for certain activities (commonly, pre-requisites for the next step) and address the need to manage the relationships that exist between the components of a total project or activity so that it is completed on time.

One major benefit of using a Gantt chart is that, once it is prepared, it allows you to see 'at a glance' where the project or activity is up to in relation to the designated time frame that has been set. This knowledge enables you to take remedial action, where necessary, to ensure the project Action Plan stays on track.

Gantt charts can also be produced that enable the allocation of funding to sub-activities and therefore the overall tracking of budget against performance and items completed.

For more information about Gantt charts go to:

- www.ganttchart.com
- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gantt_chart
- http://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newPPM_03.htm.

Life Cycle Cost Analysis (LCCA)

LCCA is a project evaluation tool.

This concept seeks to identify the total cost for a product or project (for example, the purchase of a new IT system for the venue; the cost of new facilities) over its entire life cycle by taking into account all applicable costs such as planning and design, building and implementation, maintenance and service/repairs, expenses involved in change-over, opportunity costs and/or removing existing systems or buildings to make way for the proposed project.

Use of this tool forces you to look into the future and identify *ongoing* costs associated with an initiative. Its utility comes from the fact that such a detailed analysis of ongoing costs can convert an attractive project into an unacceptable one.

Visit the following for more information:

- http://www.treasury.nsw.gov.au/_data/assets/pdf_file/0005/5099/life_cycle_costings.pdf
- <http://www.eed.state.ak.us/facilities/publications/lccahandbook1999.pdf>

Logistics support analysis (LSA)

LSA analyses the logistical support required to maintain a proposed initiative. It is an evaluation tool.

Analysis may consider, for example, the training needed for staff to operate the system being considered for purchase as part of the project (or as the root of the project), staffing levels required, spare parts and supplementary plant (and other) required to support the initiative. For example, a software program on its own is of little use – it requires a computer system to run it and physical facilities to house it.



See also:

- <http://www.logisticsworld.com/logistics.htm>

PERT charts

PERT stands for Program (or Project) Evaluation and Review Technique.

It is a technique used to plan and provide oversight for a project that is normally lengthy and complex.

It aids decision making in relation to the project.

It is associated with CPM/CPA and Gantt charts in that it provides the 'critical path' sequence for identified activities (and associated links to allied and co-dependent activities) required to complete the requirements of a project.

See also:

- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Program_Evaluation_and_Review_Technique.

Project Management Software (PMS)

PMS is a generic term referring to a range of commercially available software programmes which can be used to:

- Plan the project
- Sequence and schedule activities within the project
- Monitor the project
- Allocate project resources within the project
- Manage the project budget
- Report and communicate budget details/information.



Effective use of PMS is based on user ability with the system/software, time to use and/or learn the system, personal preferences, client demands and nature, scope, complexity and size of the project.

See:

- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Project_management_software.

A comprehensive list of various PMS and a comparison of them can be found at:

- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Comparison_of_project_management_software.

Project-specific technical resources

Supporting the above tools may be the need to use tools relating specifically to the nature of the project. This can mean there may be a need to use:

- Health, safety and welfare management system tools
- Procurement software and systems
- Staff rostering software
- MIS.

1.6 Plan internal and external communications, and public relations and marketing strategies together with appropriate colleagues

Introduction

In any workplace activity 'communication is key'.

The same applies to project management.

This section discusses important factors to consider in order to ensure project communication informs relevant stakeholders, generates positive PR (public Relations) and supports associated marketing initiatives.



Who should be involved in this planning process?

You may involve:

- Appropriate colleagues – see below
- Persons from outside the business – see below.

The 'appropriate colleagues' are:

- Senior management as identified by the property for the project
- Departmental or divisional managers especially from 'Marketing'/'Sales and Marketing'
- Project team members.

Persons from outside the business may include:

- Clients who are funding a project (function/event)
- Representative from any delegating authority – if applicable
- Representative from any funding authority – if applicable.



Planning internal communication

Internal communication refers to communications which will occur within the venue.

This is communication from you to your project team and administrative structure, and from others working in the business to you and/or members of your project team and administrative structure.

The planning process should determine:

- How communication will occur
- Frequency of communication
- Dates for reports to be published
- Topics for communication
- Communication protocols
- Formats for written communication
- Filing requirements for all communications
- Development of internal Distribution List.

Planning external communication

External communication refers to communications which occur between you and those outside the business.

External communication may be required with:

- Nominated stakeholders as identified on the Distribution List
- Government agencies and authorities
- The media
- Nominated target markets as a whole, or specific (high-value/VIP customers) from within each target market
- Local residents and the local neighbourhood
- Suppliers and providers
- Consultants for the project
- Contractors engaged for the project.

The planning process should address the topics listed above for 'internal communication' plus:

- Nomination of one person to be responsible for distributing the communications
- Nomination of one person to be responsible as the 'contact point' for external enquiries
- Budget
- Names of media to be used
- Host venue events and occasions where those on the external Distribution List will be invited to the venue.

PR strategy

Public relations is the relationship that exists between the venue and its different 'publics'. These publics may be the media, government authorities, suppliers, local neighbourhood community and all the different target markets the venue has.

The intention is to generate good public perceptions of the venue and for the project.

The PR strategy will identify how you intend achieving the goals you have set for PR in relation to the project.

Goals may include:

- Providing identified people and organisations or bodies with information. This can be in relation to:
 - A series of information releases
 - Specific information 'points' throughout the project such as start of the project, achievement of milestones, project completion
- Liaising and interacting with nominated groups or individuals by way of, for example:
 - Meetings and consultations
 - Feedback sessions
 - Visits and guided tours of the venue or project
 - Developing and publishing reports
- Responding to their questions, concerns and complaints in a variety of ways:
 - Email
 - Telephone
 - Meetings
 - Provision of information
- Involving them in what is happening through regular contact, mailouts, meetings, media releases.



Planning your PR strategy may require you to:

- Identify who you want to influence or communicate with
- Construct a database of their contact details
- Define the objectives you want to achieve
- Determine the media to be used
- Prepare and distribute media releases and/or project kits for the media
- Plan media interviews and visits to the venue
- Work out how you will monitor media and public responses to your project.

Marketing strategy

Marketing may be seen as the activities undertaken by the venue to promote and sell the products and services it provides.

Marketing also embraces a range of market research and analysis activities.

In this context (for small projects) a marketing strategy will usually emphasise 'promotion' rather than 'sales'.



A marketing strategy underpins attainment of the marketing plans of the venue.

Goals for a marketing strategy can include:

- Providing advice and information to clients, funding bodies and stakeholders
- Developing and distributing brochures, fliers and other marketing materials
- Creating and lodging paid advertisements
- Engaging in publicity for the venue/project. Publicity is a sub-set of public relations as is advertising which is generally not paid for by the business
- Including project information on the website of the business
- Capturing data relating to the project from identified groups or individuals.

Planning your marketing strategy may require you to:

- Generate information packs to be sent to stakeholders or nominated persons
- Create the content for brochures and other promotional materials
- Generate and maintain a database of those to whom information needs to be communicated
- Determining locations, frequency and schedule of paid advertisements and other unpaid promotional activities
- Confirm your marketing activities integrate with other marketing activities being undertaken by the venue.

1.7 Reach agreement on suitable project evaluation methods

Introduction

Part of the planning process for a project must be consideration of how the project will be evaluated once it has been completed.

This section identifies the need to do this and explains basic evaluation options suitable for small projects.

Reaching agreement on evaluation methods and associated factors

For small projects you may:

- Be directed about the evaluation to be employed – that is, management or a funding body will tell you what is going to apply and you have no say in it. In this case there is really no sense of ‘reaching agreement’. It is more a matter of making sure you understand what is being imposed on you
- Speak to relevant stakeholders at a meeting or workshop or series of these and:
 - Seek their advice on the most suitable evaluation options
 - Ask them to identify appropriate evaluation techniques
 - Work collaboratively with them to produce evaluation methods which synthesis and reflect their orientations
- Be required to submit your agreed evaluation to management or delegating authorities to gain their approval.



Agreement should also be sought on the following evaluation-related issues:

- Timing of the evaluation – when it is to take place
- Evaluation methods to be used – see below
- Criteria for evaluation identifying what the project will be evaluated against. This should focus on the objectives and goals contained in the project management plan
- Questions to be answered. This identifies specific questions which may be part of, or additional to, the goals and objectives for the project
- Evaluation team members identifying who will be involved in the evaluation process
- Reports, if any, to be generated outlining the contents to be addressed
- Distribution List for sharing results and outcomes and ‘lessons learned’ as identified by the evaluation.

Need to identify evaluation methods to be used

You need to determine what evaluation methods will be used to assess your project because:

- The evaluation methods agreed on will indicate priorities for aspects of the project. You will, of course, spend more time and effort on elements of the project you know are going to be evaluated
- This knowledge allows you to generate the necessary materials, evidence or data which will be required in the evaluation process
- Knowing who will participate in the evaluation should indicate people with whom you need to establish a positive working relationship
- Sometimes the focus for evaluation is **not contained** in the scope and/or objectives for the project. It can sometimes be the case that those evaluating the project intend to evaluate topics you have not considered
- The evaluation methods chosen must reflect the requirements of the project. Different projects will require different types of evaluation and even where *similar* evaluation methods are used, the specifics will normally require some form of fine tuning.

Evaluation options

All projects should be evaluated.

The extent and degree of the evaluation should reflect the size of the project. Small projects should have smaller evaluations than major projects.

For large projects a formal 'evaluation plan' may be produced but this is not usual for small projects.

Evaluating a project means analysing and assessing the outcome of the project measured against identified criteria established before the project commences.

Evaluation options for small projects may require one or more of the following alternatives to be used.

Evaluation options

Effective evaluation techniques for small projects include:

- Conducting surveys – talking to 'relevant persons' about the implementation and outcomes of the project. Surveys should:
 - Be structured so all those surveyed are asked to respond to the same questions
 - Allow free space for respondents to add issues of their choice.



Surveys may be conducted one on one, or feature the use of group surveys or focus groups:

- Applying questionnaires to nominated people. These may be paper-based or online questions posed to solicit input and feedback about the project

- Workplace observation relating to project implementation and note-taking to provide a basis for later analysis
- Engaging in pilots for aspects of the project. This features implementation of actual workplace trials of project elements to determine effectiveness, and reactions and responses from those who are impacted (such as clients, customers and staff) as well as funding bodies and delegating authorities
- Capturing and analysing *quantitative* workplace data and *qualitative* data to identify changes which have flowed as a result of the project so these can be compared against projections. Note that 'baseline data' must first be established for every aspect of data which is to be analysed. Quantitative data relates to 'figures and numbers' (known also as 'hard data') such as sales, profit, percentages, ratios, units and other information which can be presented in statistical form. Qualitative data (known also as 'soft data') refers to how people feel about the project, why they think what they think about the project and issues relating to how the project has impacted them.

1.8 Develop an overall project management plan and communicate plan to appropriate colleagues

Introduction

It is advisable to develop a project management plan for all projects including small projects.

This section identifies the possible contents of this plan and describes how to communicate this plan to others.

The project management plan

All projects should have a plan.

This plan can be referred to as the:

- Project management plan
- Project plan.

This is a hard copy plan setting out how the requirements for the project (scope and limitations) will be accommodated to achieve the identified project deliverables.

These plans reflect the size of the project; small projects have small plans and bigger projects have bigger plans.

While the content of both are similar differences often occur:

- In 'the detail' – more expensive projects have more detail
- In complexity – bigger projects are commonly longer in duration which introduces a level of complexity not found in shorter-term projects
- Stages and/or activities – bigger projects require more work to be done. The more work there is, the more planning needs to be done.



The role of the project management plan

The project management plan enables you and others involved in the execution of the project to gain a clear and comprehensive understanding of the project, especially the objectives, deliverables, constraints (cost, resources, time) before work on any aspect of the project actually commences.

It is standard procedure for the plan to be presented to management and/or the Board (or a relevant sub-committee/steering committee) for consideration and approval. They may question the plan and/or alter it as they see fit.

If you prepared the project plan they will expect you to present, explain, justify and defend it at a presentation to them.



When the Board finally approves the project management (known as signing off on the plan) this gives you official permission to carry out the work as stated in the plan. 'Signing off' also signifies the identified resources will be made available to you for the project. Please note that relatively few, if any, of these plans receive approval to proceed 'as presented'.

Doing a project plan is also a good 'due diligence' step, providing evidence of the care you took in preparing and planning for the project.

This Plan can also be used by you or others to assist them in development of future project management plans.

Reasons to have a project management plan

Undertaking any project **without** a project management plan of some sort is a guaranteed recipe for disaster.

The plan can:

- Help avoid confusion about the work to be done. It gives clarity about all aspects of the project and removes doubt about what needs to be done and what *does not* need to be done
- Provide 'authority and legitimacy' to the project. Once approved, it is an 'official' document which lends weight to it and helps you (as Project Manager) implement what it requires
- Guard against project creep
- Produce the basis for effective and efficient project execution
- Set priorities for the work to be done by allocating sequential work order
- Avoid the need to rework things once project work has actually commenced
- Indicate the way in which there is a need for cooperation and interdependency between, for example, people and departments involved in the project
- Avoid unnecessary duplication of activities, effort and expenses
- Put all project staff 'on the same' page about what needs to be done
- Provide an essential document to use for monitoring, review and evaluation purposes
- Provide a vital communication tool for stakeholders in relation to the project

- Facilitate risk planning and management
- Prescribe outcomes that can be used as the basis for guiding decision making throughout the project. This, in part, helps provide a context for decision making
- Optimise the likelihood everything that should be thought about and considered regarding the project is, in fact, identified and given the necessary attention. With a project management plan there is a less chance of important or costly things being overlooked.

Disadvantages of project planning

Several, relatively minor disadvantages attach to preparing a project management plan:

- They take time. Some will argue they take too much time especially where the timeframe for completion is short and the nature of the project is very small. The danger, people will argue, is too much time is 'wasted' on planning that should be used for 'doing something'. In some venues you may have no choice in this regard as there may be a policy *requiring* you to prepare a project management plan
- A project management plan limits flexibility. Many people feel their ability to make decisions 'on the run' or as things unfold or emerge is severely limited by the need to conform to a project management plan. Arguably this is not a severe limitation as the basis for all plans must be they are 'set in jelly and not in concrete'. The plan must be flexible to accommodate unforeseen issues and eventualities
- Significant effort can often be expended focussing on the minutiae of the project. The danger is that the focus on the bigger picture is lost or distorted.



Project management software

You may elect to use computerised packages or software designed to assist in project management.

Whether or not to use these PMS options is very much a personal choice. If you have no previous experience with using them, the potential issue is once again time. You may spend too much time trying to learn the program and align its features with the specific requirements of your project.

Where you or a project team member has experience with the use of such software it may indeed be a viable and beneficial option in terms not only of project planning but for other project management activities.

Contents of the project plan

There is no single standard format across the industry for a project management plan.

You may be required to use a format known to the venue and developed by them for use on previous projects.

You may be allowed to draft your own format, or you may be required to align with software templates in the project management software you use.

Several of the topics covered by some forms of project plans duplicate information contained in source or reference documents. This is seen as a legitimate thing to do as it 'proves' these requirements have been noted as part of the formulation of the plan. Regardless of the format, the content should cover:

- Name or title of the project. Every project should have a definite name or title to readily differentiate one project from another
- Name of the person or persons who prepared the project management plan and the date it was presented for consideration and approval. This provides a reference point in the event someone wishes to query or clarify an aspect of the plan
- Start and finish dates – see 'Timelines' immediately below.

These should apply to:

- The overall project
 - Stages of the project
- 
- Identified stages of the project describing them in words (which identify the action required and/or the final outcome for the stage) and providing start and finish dates. These 'stages' should also contain a set of supporting actions (sub-steps) to be taken to achieve the desired outcomes. These stages are the 'activities' which need to be undertaken. All activities must be allocated to one or more persons or businesses who have responsibility for their completion. When all the listed stages have been completed, the project has been finalised. See 'Work Breakdown Structure' below
 - Major stakeholders – by name, contact details and reason they are regarded as stakeholders
 - Risk identification – and management controls for those identified risks according to standard risk management procedures already undertaken. **Note:** it is standard for risk management to take place *prior* to the development of project management plan as this is often an essential element in determining the viability of the project. If risk management has already been done, the plan may include risk management activities (risk identification, risk assessment and development of risk controls). See 'Risk management' below for more information
 - Milestone information and dates – see [Section 1.9](#)
 - Resources for the project identifying specific resources (staff, physical resources, information) to achieve the project deliverables
 - Limitations and constraints applicable to the project
 - Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for use at Milestone dates and on completion of the project to help determine whether or not the project is proceeding according to schedule
 - Allocation of responsibilities to specific persons for nominated actions as identified within the Plan and its Stages
 - Budget. This should detail:
 - Total money available with information regarding how this may be spent and what it is to be spent on (and often what is **cannot** be spent on)
 - Contributions from contributing sources such as clients, agencies, the venue, head office, joint-venture partners, project sponsors

- Reporting requirements indicating:
 - Type of report, for example, inception report, progress report, and final report
 - Format of report – verbal, or formal written report
 - Distribution list
- Consultation strategies which may indicate:
 - Those with whom consultation is required
 - The nature of these consultations
 - Frequency or number of consultations necessary
 - Information required from such consultations
- QA requirements specifying, for example:
 - Standards and criteria to be applied to the project and project deliverables
 - Qualifications of those used in the project
 - Relevant compliance requirements imposed by any QA scheme used by the venue
- Internal and external communication for the project – see below 'Communication plan'
- Details of any tendering or selection process required, for example for:
 - Selecting contractors and consultants
 - Determining providers or suppliers to be used
 - Purchasing nominated products or services
- Details relating to evaluation of the project identifying those involved, dates and requirements for evaluation of the completed project.



Timelines

There will usually be two orientations to 'timelines':

- The first is the timeline or available time for the overall project. This identifies a Start and Finish date for the project as a whole. You should *always*, as a standard practice, strive to obtain as much time as possible to complete *all* projects you are asked to manage. Always try to negotiate for extra time
- The second is a set of Start and Finish dates for sub-sets of the project management plan. These dates apply to what may be called 'Stages' and 'Milestones'.

Your approach to timelines should be that when they are set or approved, they are 'law' – you must do everything in your power to make sure they are achieved.

Failing to bring a project in on time reflects very poorly on you personally regardless of any legitimate circumstances beyond your control that may have caused the over-run.

Work Breakdown Structure

Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) is a concept that can be used to assist with project planning.

It is not mandatory, but can help make sense of projects by providing the mechanism for breaking them down into smaller, more manageable sub-sets or Stages (also referred to in project management terms as 'discrete work elements').

The title of the concept indicates exactly what it does. It provides a structured breakdown of the work to be done in order for the project to be successfully completed.

The WBS reduces thinking about the project to written form enabling others to see the separate stages, identify the thinking behind the phases that have been decided on, identify the need for integration of certain actions with other actions (inter-dependency and co-dependency), and see the sequential nature of the project and all its component parts.

The Stages are the major phases of the project which together combine to produce the identified outcomes or deliverables for the project. Developing a suite of Stages makes it easier to determine the specific actions for each Stage, rather than trying to identify and sequence all the activities required for the entire project at once.

A structured form is used when applying WBS – a tree-like form with branches coming off at various points to indicate work to be done and sequencing. Codes are used to identify activities and events.

A WBS can be hand-drawn or produced using PMS.

Important points to remember when using WBS are:

- 'The 100% rule' – meaning the activity must cover all the requirements (100%) of the project
- The 100% rule also means actions outside the scope of the project must not be covered
- There must be no duplication between elements of the project in terms of their attribution in the WBS.



Be prepared to spend many hours constructing a WBS for any significant process and make sure you do not fall for the common trap of trying to rush the process so you can begin 'real' work; that is getting on with the project.

In reality, some projects warrant more time spent on the WBS than is spent actually implementing the plan.

For really small projects, experienced Project Managers can almost conduct a WBS for the project in their head based on previous experience, knowledge of the context and identified project requirements.

Websites of value for WBS include:

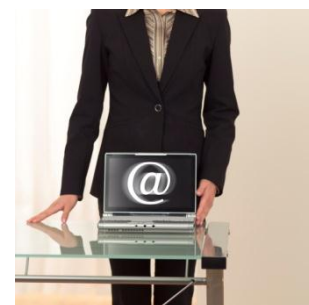
- http://www.hyperhot.com/pm_wbs.htm
- <http://www.anticlue.net/archives/000964.htm>.

Communicating the plan

A meeting with all relevant people (that is, anyone who has responsibility allocated to them in the project management plan, or their supervisor) is the only way to effectively communicate the project management which has been developed.

You cannot effectively communicate the plan simply by emailing it to people or by giving them a copy of the plan.

You must supplement your verbal explanation with a copy of the plan but never believe distributing the plan equates to 'communicating' the plan.



Planning and preparation

Standard planning and preparation for this meeting should occur to optimise attendance and effectiveness:

- Arrange a forum for the meeting – a nominated room
- Arrange a date and time in consultation with those who are required to attend
- Notify those who need to attend using their known communication preference
- Follow up with those invited or required to attend to encourage their attendance
- Arrange catering – tea, coffee, water
- Plan the presentation – this is vital. Your competency as PM will be inferred from the way you make the presentation. You need to:
 - Determine content for the presentation
 - Identify the sequence in which information will be delivered
 - Choose method of delivery
 - Generate supporting materials for handouts
 - Prepare PowerPoint slides
 - Arrange guest speaker (manager, owner, client as appropriate) to present aspects of the presentation
- Distribute materials in advance of the meeting as and where appropriate to encourage people to pre-read them, identify issues they will need explaining and develop appropriate questions they want to ask
- Follow up after the meeting with those who could not attend, and with those where extra information was to be provided.



What needs to be communicated?

Depending on the project there may be a need to address:

- Distribution and/or explanation of all project-related plans. Standard practice is to ask project team members to treat these (and all other documents provided) as 'commercial in confidence'. In this context may relate to:
 - Project management plan
 - Communication plan
 - Risk management plan
 - Marketing plan
- Budget data – covering types of resources available; amounts; budget and other codes; how to access resources; requirements for making purchases on behalf of the venue for the project
- Preferred lines of communication for project activities to facilitate and optimise communication



- Lines of responsibility as they apply for the project. These are often different to what normally applies so they need to be addressed and explained
- Delegation of authority for the project including delegation of tasks, responsibilities, roles
- Accountability for allocated duties
- Contact numbers and details – extension numbers, mobile phone numbers, fax numbers, pager numbers, email addresses
- All aspects of whatever is contained in the project management plan for the project. This can include coverage of attendant or sub-plans; timing requirements and/or constraints; resources; outcomes, objectives and deliverables; KPIs; reporting requirements
- Emergency response plans for the project detailing what they cover, responsibilities, drills, trigger points for action
- Health, safety and welfare issues. A project will often raise additional or different issues requiring standard risk management attention.

This may mean certain issues need:

- To be investigated by designated people or agencies
- Job Safety Analysis sheets and procedures prepared for them
- Specific on-site safety training
- Provision and use of designated safety clothing and/or equipment
- Your role as PM identifying what you will be doing and what staff can expect from you in terms of assistance, supervision, monitoring, oversight, decision making, and general support and liaison. A declaration regarding your 'open door' policy should be made
- Identification of scheduled project meetings. This should cover timing and location of regular scheduled project meetings and emphasis on the role of these meetings and the importance of the need to attend these.

How may this communication occur?

Several options exist:

- Face to face meeting. This is the best option as it allows better follow-up to occur, incorporates non-verbal communication into the process and enables project team members to meet other project team members
- Email. This may be useful to supplement face to face meetings, for example, where extra information needs to be disseminated
- Telephone. This can be useful for contacting team members who could not attend the scheduled main meeting. This can be the case where part-time or casual staff from the venue are included as team members but cannot attend the initial induction meeting due to work or other commitments
- Staff meeting or briefing. For small projects, the daily staff briefing or meeting can double as the induction meeting for project staff.

Risk management

Risk is inherent in every project – no project is ever truly risk free.

It is a fact of life that bigger projects and projects of a longer duration tend to have more risks to be considered.

It is also true many small, short-term projects have no formal risk management done for them.

The basis for formal risk management

Risk management comprises a three-step process:

- Identify risks
- Analyse and evaluate risks. This is also known as risk appraisal
- Control the risks.



Risk types

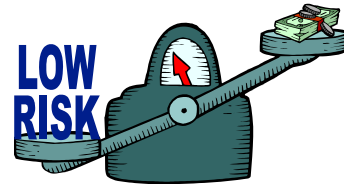
Risks for a project may be classified as:

- Project-specific risks relating to issues effecting, or likely to be impacted by, the project
- Customer risk. These are risks faced by customers as a result of the project being undertaken at the venue: health, safety and welfare considerations are critical here to ensure the safety of all patrons
- Staff risks. This includes risks faced by staff who are participating in delivering or servicing the project. Once again, health, safety and welfare considerations are important and attention should be paid to investigating how the project increases or changes the hazards staff might normally encounter
- Funding or financial risks relating to, for example, cost over-runs; unforeseen or unexpected expenses; failure of financial institutions to provide funding as arranged, promised or expected for the project
- Outcome or performance risks relating to issues where project deliverables are not being (or, have not been) provided as required or anticipated
- Environmental risks which may address possible pollution issues arising from noise, air, water and/or waste disposal
- Technological risks which may arise if the wrong 'system' is used or purchased. This may relate to ensuring an outdated system is not purchased; ensuring the purchase of a new system or equipment will integrate with existing systems or will integrate with other systems to be bought or might be needed in the future
- Legal risks relating to issues where the venue fails to comply with legislated requirements and/or breaches enforceable contractual provisions.

Risk Management Plan

For each relevant or identified risk you should:

- Identify and describe the risk comprehensively and accurately insofar as this is possible using qualitative description (defining and describing the risk) and quantitative description (attaching figures, numbers and statistics to the risk)
- Place each identified risk into a project-specific Risk Register
- Give each risk a code or number to help locate it on the internal venue system. This code can also be used as the basis for further action, funding and reference purposes
- Calculate the likelihood of each identified risk occurring in descriptive terms such as 'Very likely', 'Likely', 'Unlikely' or 'Very unlikely'
- Determine the severity of the consequence of each identified risk if it occurs. This may be in statistical terms or 'Major', 'Serious', 'Minor' or 'Insignificant'
- Tabulate the likelihood and consequence of each risk to determine its rating such as 'Low', 'Medium', 'High' and 'Extreme'
- Develop coping and control mechanisms to be adopted by the venue to address each identified risk – see 'Options in response to identified risk' and 'Contingency Plans'.



Project-based risk evaluation tools

Most risk management for industry-based projects are determined on the basis of experience, previous venue history and formal investigation into the project.

Experience and previous history

This involves:

- Gathering together staff who have worked on previous similar projects and seeking their input regarding risk management. It is really useful to speak to previous Project Managers. If previous PMs have left the venue, try to find out where they are now and talk to them
- Speaking to management (and other relevant stakeholders – internal and/or external) about their recollections regarding previous projects
- Analysing documentation within the business to identify lessons learned such as reading previous contracts, project reviews and evaluation reports and results
- Conducting Brainstorming sessions to identify possible risks.

Formal investigation

This can include:

- Paying for the services of a professional, external project management business who have experience (a) with this type of project, and (b) the hospitality industry
- Using fault-tree analysis (FTA) and/or Fishbone (Ishikawa) diagrams. These are techniques used to help identify possible causes for a risk and relate these possible causes to each other and the projected result or outcome of the risk eventuating (linking cause and effect)

- Software programs can be used to assist with these. It is not recommended you use these approaches unless you have previous experience with them, or unless you have someone to help you who has previous experience with them.

See also:

- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fault_tree_analysis
- http://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newTMC_03.htm.

Options in response to identified risk

Responses to individual risks must be individually selected. It is not possible to provide a 'blanket statement' approach to risk control.

The action to be taken where possible should always be such that it addresses the expected cause of the hazard occurring.



Standard generic responses to project risk include:

- Risk avoidance – that is, not proceeding with the project
- Accepting and controlling the risk – taking action to alter either the likelihood of the risk occurring, and/or reducing the consequence of the risk if it does occur
- Transferring the risk. This involves taking out appropriate insurance to cover the project, and/or outsourcing all or most of the work to reduce the liability and exposure of the organisation
- Deferring the risk – postponing the project till a later date
- Limiting the risk – only proceeding with part of the original project proposal.

Contingency plans

Your project may require you to prepare or consider 'Contingency plans' for your project.

Contingency plans are 'Plan B'.

They govern what could or should be done when a situation arises where the initial plans cannot be implemented and/or the actions to be taken when an identified risk actually occurs.

The factors uncovered as part of risk management will determine to a great extent what the contingency plans cover, and how extensive they are.

Not all projects – especially very small, very short-term projects – have contingency plans prepared.

Risk management plans and Contingency plans should be included as part of the formal project management plan. Some venues may establish a Risk Register to assist with detailing and recording specifics of identified risks.

1.9 Identify key project milestones and communicate these to persons involved

Introduction

Where a formal project management plan has been developed these will normally contain milestones to assist with monitoring progress of the project.

This section describes the role of project milestones and indicates how these should be communicated.

Milestones defined

Milestones are points in time when nominated activities are expected to be completed, or times when important decisions need to be taken about subsequent action.

Milestones occur at significant points in the project such as the end of a stage (or combination of stages) for a project.

They can be seen as project checkpoints or benchmarks.

There is no standard timeline for the setting of milestones. The key factor in determining when and where they occur are an estimation of the time required to achieve completion of the work which has to be undertaken.

This means:

- Some milestones are much longer or shorter than others
- Multiple milestones can occur at the same point in the project.

Setting milestones allows you to monitor the actual progress of the project against projected or anticipated progress of the project.

Milestones should reflect the flow (order/sequence) of the activities required to complete the project and may be allocated:

- A number – such as ‘Stage 1’, ‘Stage 2’ and so on
- A written descriptor – such as ‘Tenderers’ and Consultants researched, identified and contracted’, ‘Fixtures and fittings removed and room prepare for fit-out’.

In most cases the achievement of one milestone indicates the start of another one.

Identifying milestones

Milestones should be identified as part of the planning process for the project.

As you have seen they should be incorporated into the project management plan.

When identifying milestones:

- Ensure you know the start and finish date for the project. These are the two parameters within which all milestones must fit
- Make sure you have identified all work which needs to be undertaken to complete the project. This work will need to be converted to Stages which often form the basis for a milestone



- Verify you have scheduled the required work in the proper sequence as milestones reflect the progressive nature of the project
- Where *subsequent* work or action relies on work being completed, the milestones for the previous milestones must precede the later ones
- Involve others in assisting identify the Stages of the project and the milestones which should apply. Asking others to contribute always helps ensure correct sequencing and scheduling of activities and helps make sure nothing is overlooked in the planning process. This requirement is especially applicable to:
 - Contractors
 - External providers
 - Consultants
- Include penalty clauses applicable to external providers and contractors if they fail to meet milestone requirements and ensure they sign-off on these
- Seek approval from key stakeholders for the milestones you have tentatively identified
- Look for logical 'breaks' in the project which automatically qualify as obvious milestones
- Set a date **before** the milestone is due as an inspection or check date. This is where you examine actual progress against the requirements of the upcoming milestone giving you time to take whatever remedial or catch-up action is needed to attain the requirements of the milestone
- Realise many PMS systems have a 'Create a milestone' facility and this may be useful to you
- Determine the meetings, inspections and/or reports which must attach to each identified milestone.



Communicating the milestones

Previous advice relating to communication of the project management plan applies to communicating milestones.

Attention must be paid to:

- Ensuring the applicable dates are understood by everyone. They should be encouraged to diarise them
- You should also send out advanced notice about them as the date approaches to remind people
- Giving each relevant person a project management plan with the milestones for which they have responsibility highlighted
- Detailing exactly what each milestone comprises so there is certainty about what should be completed
- Advising people of action to take when and if they believe milestones they have responsibility for will not be completed by the scheduled date
- Notifying people of the flow-on implications of milestones not being achieved as specified and by the time specified
- Checking the budget as part of the process of checking milestones.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

NOTE: This Work Project can form the basis for Work Projects 2.1 and 3.1.

- 1.1 To meet the requirements for this Work Project you are required to identify and describe a small project (which may be an actual project or a simulated mock project) and provide details regarding planning the project as follows:
- Develop objectives and scope for it
 - Nominate who are the external stakeholders
 - Identify the resources required and how you would obtain them
 - Explain how you would determine the financial viability of the project
 - Provide an administrative structure for the project
 - Develop a detailed project management plan for the project
 - Create as applicable a communications plan or strategy and public relations and marketing strategy
 - Identify the evaluation methods to be used when project has been completed
 - Explain how plans, strategies and milestones for the project will be communicated to relevant stakeholders.
-

Summary

Plan project

When planning projects:

- Make sure you know the scope and objectives
- Determine the project deliverables
- Consult widely with stakeholders and relevant others
- Identify resources required and prepare a resource strategy
- Determine the financial viability of the project as part of standard operating procedure
- Develop an administrative structure for the project
- Manage your time effectively
- Allocate responsibilities for work to be done
- Undertake risk management activities
- Prepare a project management plan with contingency plans
- Develop PR and marketing strategies appropriate to and if required for the project
- Communicate plans with internal and external stakeholders
- Consider use of project management software
- Determine the methods to be used to evaluate the project.

Element 2:

Administer and monitor project

2.1 Implement and monitor project in conjunction with project team members

Introduction

When the planning for a project has been completed and all necessary authorisations have been obtained, the next step is to start the project.

This section identifies issues and requirements for implementing and monitoring the project.

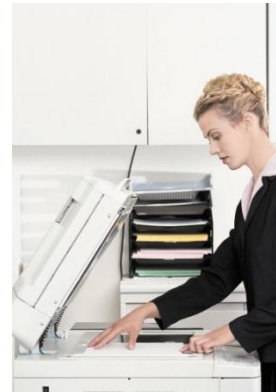
Standard practice

From this point forward the extent to which the project succeeds or fails rests with this phase.

It is where you have to 'walk the talk' – to put into practice the plans you developed and which have been approved.

Standard practice at the outset is to:

- Verify all requirements for project start have been met. You would for instance require:
 - Copies of relevant authorizations which have been signed-off
 - Direct approval from the manager or owner to proceed
- Look at your own workload for the project period and take appropriate action to ensure you can commit the required time to the project, which may involve:
 - Prioritising work
 - Delegating work
 - Creating a personal work schedule
 - Diarising time you have committed to the project
- Meet with the client to enquire if they have any final requirements additional to what is already known
- Communicate with other supervisors and managers to advise them of the project and the fact it is about to start
- Convene a meeting of your staff and team to brief them on the project and its commencement
- Advise staff and project teams the project has been officially approved and notify them of any last-minute changes made
- Identify any other workplace projects or activities which the project can or should be integrated with to achieve savings and other efficiencies.



Implementing and monitoring project management plans

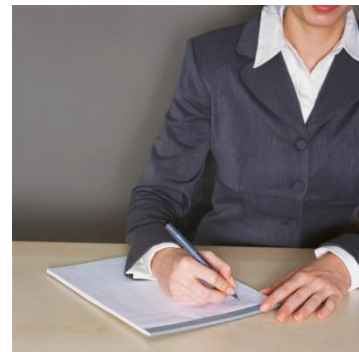
Without suitable management any project will quickly start to display signs of problems.

Effective project management demands:

- Attention to project management. It sounds basic but it is so important. You must allocate sufficient time and focus to doing just this: 'managing the project'. Project management must take priority and others in the venue (supervisors, managers, staff) have to realise this. You have to make them accept and understand your primary focus is the project (as well as completing other day to day duties you normally have responsibility for)
- You are a constant physical presence. All projects benefit from the PM being present and available. 'Being there' encourages questions from people and organisations who are not sure about what to do. Being there demonstrates the importance you place on the project. Being there at all times allows you to see what is going on and intervene when things are not going according to what you know to be the plan or requirements. 'Being there' means being on the project work site – not being hidden away in an office somewhere. You can never successfully manage any project only from an office
- Facilitation of the work of others involved in the project, whether they are internal staff or team members or external third-party providers, consultants or contractors. Facilitation can mean literally hundreds of things such as:
 - Opening the venue early so workers can gain access
 - Authorising entry to restricted areas
 - Providing information as required to enable decision making
 - Taking charge of a situation and making decisions about what can and cannot be done
 - Giving permission or authority to vary an approach, standard, timeline or deliverable
 - Using your authority to prioritise conflicting or competing requirements of the venue and of the project
- Engagement with the project. This can only be achieved through a detailed knowledge of the project plan combined with regular interaction with the people involved in the project. This necessitates frequent communication (formal and informal – briefings, meetings and impromptu discussion) and, as already identified, being a constant physical presence and talking to people before they begin their work, while they are working and when they finish
- Constant monitoring of the project. This involves constant regular evaluating and measuring of 'actual' progress against 'projected' progress as set out in the project management plan. This monitoring should extend to:
 - KPIs
 - Budget
 - Project criteria and standards



- Labour – are more staff needed? Are the project team members providing an effective labour force for the project?
 - Unstated expectations. Even though the project scope and project plan will detail many expectations for the project, there are nearly always additional ‘unstated’ expectations. These can relate to almost anything but common unstated expectations relate to:
 - The time project work will start and finish each day
 - Days on which there will be no project work
 - The level of inconvenience the project causes to normal venue operations
 - Identified risk and the controls being used to address them
 - Impact of the project on customers/guests and service delivery
 - Checking and double-checking what others have said:
 - Have promises been kept as and when stated?
- Attendance at all project meetings. As PM you are duty bound to be present at each and every project meeting. This means attending them regardless of when they are convened and regardless of other work you have to do. As soon as you miss just one project meeting, regardless of how legitimate your reason for not being there is, others will misinterpret this as a lack of dedication and enthusiasm and their commitment to the project will begin to falter. This means you must attend all project-related meetings which may be called by the Board, stakeholders, staff, management, contractors, delegating authorities, committees **without exception**
- Ability to foresee potential problems and raise them with relevant others to address them before they convert into actual problems and issues. This ability must apply to scheduling clashes; potential delays; labour issues; funding shortfalls; procurement; delivery; installation and commissioning
- Constant note-taking. As PM you should make lots and lots of notes in your Project Notebook (see below). Never rely on your memory about things that happened; things that failed to happen; what was said (by way of a promise or commitment by another person) face to face or over the phone. Always write it down
- High levels of time management. This is fundamental to any successful PM role.
- You must spend some time working out how you are going to spend your time – planning the use of your time is vital. There will **never** be enough time for you to do all you have to do (‘normal’ work plus project activities) and extra work will **always** emerge on an almost daily basis as the project progresses. Some tips to better manage your time include:
- Get to work earlier and leave later. This may not be what you want to hear but it can be your reality for at least part of most projects
 - Learn to say no. Say ‘No’ to other work that is not part of the project: delegation is an effective tool in this regard



- Bundle similar tasks. This is basic time management at work stuff:
 - Only read emails once or twice per day as opposed to every 30 or 60 minutes
 - Write reports at the one time each day or each week
 - Hold all your briefings or meetings at the same part of the day. The meeting with staff could be at 3:45PM; meeting with the Manager at 4:00PM; meeting with suppliers and contractors at 4:30PM; meeting with the Board at 5:00PM
- Taking of remedial action as required. Sometimes this will require communication with others (internal and external) but often it is a matter of you making an on the spot decision to:
 - Overcome a problem
 - Direct staff about what to do, when and/or how to do something
 - Solve a stalemate situation
 - Approve or authorise a suggestion made to you by someone else
 - Modify the project management plan.

Project notebook

It is a good idea for you to have a project notebook.

This small book is used to record information relating to the project that is obtained:

- By walking around the venue or project and observing what is happening
- As verbal feedback from stakeholders
- As a result of a telephone call with a stakeholder
- As a flash of inspiration while working on the project.

Not all relevant details of a project can be captured using even the most extensive and comprehensive reporting and monitoring system so the project notebook really is a vital tool.

The information in the project notebook can be used as the basis for:

- Formal reports
- General reference
- Clarification of options, conflicting ideas and suggestions and information received
- Information disseminated to project team members
- Determining action to resolve issues, delays and problems
- Resource provision
- Personal reminders of action that needs to be taken.

When project team members and others see you taking notes this also sends a very strong message about your commitment to the project and how seriously you are taking it.

You will find, not unexpectedly, people will tend to make more considered and honest responses to you when they suspect their words may be 'taken down' for future reference.

Managing quality

Most deliverables in a project have some form of quality criteria attached to them. These may be specified in the project management plan or simply be understood but unstated.

You are expected not only to ensure tasks are completed but completed to the required standards.

Keys in achieving this are:

- Ensuring you know the quality standards or criteria for all aspects of the project. Remember the concept of quality is variable and often difficult to define but there is usually a strong link between the amount paid for a product or service and the level of quality received. The point is that not all quality for a project will be 'top' quality. The project may specify a lower level of quality (for a cheaper price) that is still acceptable to needs
- Monitoring 'quality' as an important issue at every meeting with all stakeholders. This means letting them know you are concerned with quality and will be checking it.

This helps avoid problems associated with quality caused by 'near enough is good enough' thinking

- Meeting with project team members, suppliers, contractors and similar *prior* to their involvement to explain quality requirements and to give them an opportunity to ask relevant questions and clarify expectations
- Undertaking regular quality inspections of work completed as opposed to simply allowing finished work to go unchecked. Providers tend to do a better job where they know their work will be checked, and know they will be asked to repeat or redo sub-standard work. It is a good idea to undertake these inspections with the providers, staff and contractors so you can identify and discuss issues on the spot
- Ensuring all sub-standard work is redone to the quality standard required by making sure all identified sub-standard work is fixed. One of the worst things that can happen in terms of quality is for the provider, staff or contractors to perform sub-standard work, know you have identified it as such, and find they are allowed to 'get away with it': This sends a message that you will accept 'anything' and their standard will drop to deliver similar poor quality across nearly all deliverables
- Referring contractors, project staff and others to the project management plan (and/or relevant contracts) where reference is made to quality standards or criteria so they can see for themselves what is required.



2.2 Provide support and assistance to team members, as required

Introduction

A vital role when administering and monitoring a project is the provision of necessary support for your project team or teams.

This section indicates the need for this support and assistance and provides examples of what might be done to provide it.

Need to provide support and assistance

Support and assistance needs to be provided to project team members to:

- Enable successful outcomes of project deliverables as approved by stakeholders and as identified in the project management plan and scope. Staff cannot deliver what is required unless they have the facilities and resources to perform the work
- Demonstrate your commitment to the team members and the project and your commitment to the project
- Show the respect you have for team members and the role they play in delivering the project: see also [Section 2.3](#)
- Maintain enthusiasm of team members towards the project.

A vital element of the support a PM can provide to project team members is to maintain personal enthusiasm for the project

- Enable prompt advice and direction to be given where and when necessary so the project can proceed without delay
- Prove to management of the venue you are delivering appropriate management, supervision and oversight of the project.

Examples of support

Once again the nature and scope of the project will determine much of the support needed, but possibilities include:

- Conducting a Project Induction (also known as or referred to as 'project start-up activities') – a special meeting/briefing to explain the project, identify the resources, specific timelines, share the project management plan and allocate responsibilities
- Actually providing the resources identified in the project plan and identified in the project induction. This can include:
 - Providing codes or other information to enable team members to access resources and/or information
 - Providing formal authority to make purchases on behalf of the project
 - Providing internal authorities (codes, identification cards, keys) to enable access to areas, facilities, stores and other project-related areas



- Recruiting necessary staff to fill required roles
- Physically supplying resources to teams and team members – that is, handing things over
- Working with other managers and supervisors to arrange for release of venue staff from normal duties to participate in project work and facilitating backfilling where necessary
- Provision of necessary training and development for team members to enable them to better perform their allocated tasks under the project plan. Training and development may be informal, in-house training or off-the-job, formal, accredited training
- Providing necessary, requested and/or promised project oversight by providing supervision, monitoring, coaching, direction and guidance
- Scheduling and/or conducting regular project team meetings. Some projects require daily (or twice daily) meetings: one in the morning before work starts and the other at the end of the day or shift. A minimum should be at least one meeting per week otherwise there is too much disconnect between the team and the project. These meetings provide a forum for:
 - Raising project-related issues
 - General communication regarding satisfaction levels with progress, feedback on support being provided, changes being identified as the project progresses, and 'issues arising'
 - Identifying and resolving workplace health, safety and welfare matters
 - Identifying and resolving team-related issues such as problems within the team, team composition, capabilities of the team, size of the team and relationship within the team and between the team and others
- Providing initial motivation to team members by explaining why the project is of value to the venue and stakeholders. You may refer to one or more of the following as appropriate as legitimate motivation:
 - Enhanced job security for everyone in the venue
 - Potential for increased earnings, more challenging work, deeper job satisfaction
 - A safer workplace
 - A more prestigious workplace or venue as a result of the success of the project
 - Meeting what the competition is doing
 - Leading the field in terms of the initiative that is the focus of the project
- Giving time to the team. This can occur in a number of ways:
 - Being seen in the project area as a visible presence
 - Spending time talking to project staff
 - Helping them think through challenges and problems
 - Sharing their successes and their disappointments in terms of project work
 - Providing ongoing motivation



- Maintaining enthusiasm for the project by, as appropriate or necessary:
 - Providing ongoing encouragement to team members for effort as well as work done
 - Empathising and sympathising to show concern for individuals
 - Passing on comments from others including positive and negative feedback
 - Confirming for the team the progress they are making against plans and the KPIs and milestones
 - Celebrating the achievement of project milestones.



2.3 Build trust and respect within the project team

Introduction

You must build trust and respect with your project team/ to optimise the chance of success for any project.

This section presents suggestions for how this can be achieved.

Need to build trust and respect

Building trust and respect within the project team is not an option; it is a necessity for the following reasons:

- You have to understand *your* success as PM rests very much on the work done by those who support you. **You** will be judged (by venue management and other stakeholders) on how well or how badly **they** perform their allocated tasks
- Generating trust and respect is a fundamental basis for attaining the identified goals and objectives for the project. This reflects the interpersonal nature of relationships in the workplace. If people do not like or respect you then this translates into the work they do for you
- If you help others achieve their wants and goals then they are more likely to help you achieve yours. All workers want to be trusted and respected
- Physical and financial resources are useless and irrelevant without the human resources needed to apply them
- Where there is no trust there can only be fear and a lack of faith about what needs to be done to achieve the identified goals. Fear leads to paralysis and this will greatly impeded project success.

Points to note

- Trust and respect is a two-way street – there must be mutual respect.

You must have trust and respect for your project team and they must have trust and respect for you

- You cannot order or direct someone to have trust and respect
- You have to *give* trust and respect to your team

- You have to *earn* trust and respect for yourself
- Trust and respect is the result of a combination of factors such as:
 - Honesty
 - Reliability
 - Credibility
 - Understanding
 - Commitment
 - Good communication
 - Consultation and collaboration
- Trust and respect are established over time.



Ways to build trust and respect

The following will help you build trust and respect with your project team:

- Doing more yourself than you expect them to do. It is vital you lead by example and demonstrate your capacity for work
- Avoid micro-managing them. Give them a job and let them determine how to do it unless it has to be done in a certain way
- Value each member of the team. See the project team as individuals rather than an vague conglomerate of people
- Get to know the people in the team. Learn their names, about their likes and dislikes, their personal history and about their expectations
- Use their names when talking to them. This demonstrates you have made an effort to get to know them
- Communicate with all of them on a regular basis. Keep the lines of communication open
- Provide and encourage constructive feedback
- Give them responsibility. Nothing demonstrates trust or faith in staff better than actually placing trust in them to complete work which has been allocated to them
- Celebrate the individuality of your team members. Diversity can be a cornerstone of success
- Pitch in and do some hands-on work yourself to contribute to the project as opposed to only being seen to undertake management duties: demonstrate your competency
- Congratulate them regularly but make sure the congratulations are 'earned' and legitimate. Congratulate them:
 - Individually and face to face
 - At team briefings and meetings
 - When they have done good work
 - When they achieve a KPI or milestone



- If they make a mistake, do not lecture them. Instead take a constructive approach and:
 - Identify what went wrong – adopting a ‘no blame’ policy
 - Explain or demonstrate the correct way
 - Avoid being angry, vindictive or aggressive
- Encourage their input, opinions and feedback. Never be afraid of listening to what team members have to say or contribute
- Spend some time with them in a social context instead of only interacting with them in a work or project-related setting
- Never play favourites. Avoid situations where:
 - You spend more time with some team members than others
 - You give ‘better’ jobs to some team members but not to others
 - You discipline some team members but not others for the same issue
 - You provide more opportunities to some but not to others
 - You give more freedom or latitude to some but not to others
- Address issues and problems promptly as opposed to ignoring them and allowing them to fester and grow
- Advise your manager about the good work done by your team and/or individual members of the team. Make sure you never take credit for the work of others.

2.4 Assess and review progress against project goals and in consultation with project team members

Introduction

Central elements in administering and monitoring a project are to assess and review progress against the project management plan.

This section identifies the topics which may be considered and presents options for undertaking the assessment and review process.

Need to assess and review progress

You need to assess and review project progress to:

- Compare actual progress against expected or anticipated progress
- Provide a basis for taking remedial or corrective action where the analysis shows a lack of progress against plans such as:
 - Allocating more staff or time to the project
 - Providing additional resources – see [Section 2.5](#)



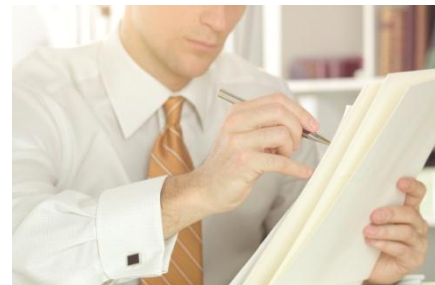
- Changing suppliers or contractors
- Revising the project management plan to allow, for example, more time to complete stages or to include work which was not originally identified (or required by the client)
- Enable accurate and honest feedback and reports on the project to be given to you from project team and stakeholders
- Give your project team and other stakeholders necessary feedback
- Allow you to integrate other work and projects with your existing workload.

Topics for consideration

Aims and objectives

The aims of this process are to:

- Confirm activities which are being achieved as planned
- Identify activities which are running behind schedule or which present the potential to run behind schedule
- Identify activities which are not achieving the required levels, standards or criteria
- Determine action to be taken to bring the project back on track in terms of the project management plan and within the prescribed parameters for the project.



There are two broad focuses for assessment and review of a project:

- The project management plan
- Issues arising.

Project management plan

The project management plan should provide the framework for the analysis and identify specific topics which need to be assessed and reviewed.

If anything exists in the project plan then it must be considered.

The evaluation process is a case of asking a series of questions to determine progress as measured against the specifics of the project plan.

Previous notes (especially [Section 1.8](#)) have identified the possible contents of your project management plans and at this stage you should revisit them to determine exactly what they are.

Topics for consideration will relate to:

- Deliverables for the project in terms of what has happened (past events/work) and what can be foreseen (future project-related activities and outcomes):
 - Are they being achieved?
 - Are stages of the project running on track with the timelines set for them?
 - Are milestones being achieved?

- Are future deliverables at risk?
- Why is this the case? What are the causal reasons?
- How will the current situation impact the rest of the project?
- Budget. This should be addressed to:
 - Check money has been spent as expected and only as authorized
 - Verify the amount which remains in the budget
 - Determine if the budget can realistically be expected to support and enable completion of the project
 - Validate expenses have been allocated to correct budgets and budget lines
 - Ensure expected income has translated into actual income
 - Calculate the extent to which extra finance may be required, what it is needed for and why it is necessary
- Quality. The standards and criteria set for the project as part of the planning phase must be included in the assessment and review to:
 - Verify the required standards are being achieved
 - Determine any rectification work which has to be undertaken to retrieve outcomes which have failed to achieve the required standard
 - Serve as a warning to providers and staff that their work is actually being monitored
- Customer satisfaction. This requires attention in terms of the following:
 - Determining customer responses to any interruptions or reductions to standard service provision caused by the project
 - Determining customer satisfaction and response to any aspects of the project with which the guests/customers now have access or are experiencing (such as refurbished rooms, different workplace protocols, new facilities)
 - Determining the extent to which the project outcomes at this stage have met their expectations
- Efficient use of resources which addresses:
 - Verifying only necessary goods and services have been bought to ensure there is no excess purchasing of items
 - Checking to ensure waste levels of goods and/or services is not excessive
 - Monitoring the use of all resources (as identified in the project plan) and that they are being used in accordance with stated need.

Issues arising

Assessment and review activities must always consider 'issues arising' for a project.

These are the unexpected occurrences which materialise throughout the life of most projects.

They can be positive (beneficial to the project and/or to the venue or other projects) or negative.

Examples of issues commonly arising with projects include (but are not limited to):

- Problems with third party providers such as them:
 - Failing to perform work as promised or contracted
 - Not finishing work by the required date
 - Using sub-standard materials
 - Imposing price increases
- Difficulties with the work/project teams such as:
 - Internal conflict within the team
 - Other areas of the venue demanding team members work on other tasks
 - Individuals not being able to perform as expected
- Issues involving the client/delegating body such as:
 - Changing their mind about previously agreed arrangements
 - Wanting more for the same money now you are committed to and have started the project
 - Inability to communicate as and when needed with them to seek advice and direction
- Lack of cooperation from internal sources such as:
 - Other departments or supervisors not releasing the staff you want to work on the project
 - Slow processing of requests such as purchase orders, requisitions, payments and general paperwork
- Involvement of external agencies or authorities who may:
 - Impose extra compliance requirements on the project as the project progresses and inspectors identify additional requirements they believe you must comply with.



Practical application

Techniques to optimise effective assessment and review of project progress include:

- Schedule time for regular assessment and review. You must allocate time for this aspect of project management. Never assume you will be able to 'make time' for it or that you will have enough time to undertake this activity
- Plan meetings with the team and relevant stakeholders to discuss progress and advise them well in advance of when and where these will take place
- Do your own analysis first before you participate in assessment and review with the team. You need to develop your own perspective on where things are at before you engage with others on this topic



- Engage with the project team and other relevant stakeholders as part of the process. They will be able to contribute valuable insight and information and they need to be made aware of how you (as the one responsible for the project) have evaluated the progress
- Tell the team exactly what is the focus for *this* assessment and review so they are certain about the aim of the process and know what is *not* being considered. Make sure they have access to the agreed project management plan so they can refer to the topics being discussed and can see for themselves the targets and outcomes being considered were actually contained in the plan at the outset
- Make sure you have allocated sufficient time for this process and for all meetings which need to take place as part of the process. These assessment and review meetings **always** take longer than you would expect. This is because:
 - It is possible for different people to judge 'progress' in different ways. Not everyone sees progress in the same way. Certainly *your* interpretation of progress is likely to be different to that of the team members to some extent regardless of how objective you try to be
 - Team members can become very defensive when their work is criticized (no matter how sensitively you do it) and you need to spend some time supporting them and addressing personal issues which will emerge as a result
 - There can be significant discussion and debate over the remedial action which needs to be taken to retrieve a situation which is 'out of control'
 - There are nearly always considerable contributions relating to the 'issues arising' part of the process
- Refresh the project team about why the assessment and review needs to occur so they understand the reasons for it and do not simply think you are 'checking up' on them and their work. Remind them they were advised this process was a standard part of your intentions for project management, and is not an indication something is wrong, you are displeased or the client is upset
- Conducting workplace inspections of project-related completed activities and activities in progress with members of the project team so everyone can see the progress at the same time and there is therefore less uncertainty about:
 - What has been done
 - The quality of the work which has been done
 - Physical problems which exist or can be seen as emerging
- Using actual 'evidence' as the basis for the assessment and review. The aim must be to use *objective* proof as the basis for process. This will include:
 - Conducting workplace inspections – see above
 - Making actual reference to relevant documentation as opposed to basing decisions on memory
 - Using actual statistics and data in order to make judgements as distinct from using half-truths and 'beliefs'



- Advising the team members of the possible implications if the plan cannot be achieved according to the plan prepared for it so they understand a lack of progress has consequences and they are well aware of what these might be. Ensuring the assessment and review process is a positive one for those involved. This can be difficult to achieve where it is obvious the project is behind schedule or otherwise failing to meet the deliverables set for it. This, however, underlines the need for you to plan the meeting so you can:
 - Identify and draw attention to the positives which exist. There will always be many of these if you look hard enough
 - Remain positive in your approach and demeanour. If you are down-beat and pessimistic this will rub off on the team
 - Explain how the situation may be retrieved and brought back on track.

2.5 Determine the need for additional project resources and take action accordingly

Introduction

Resources underpin the achievement of every project regardless of its size or nature.

This section provides more information about resources, discusses the need to determine the need for additional resources and presents possible action to obtain extra resources.

More information on resources

As a successful Project Manager you must be able to access sufficient resources to enable the attainment of the objectives, outcomes or deliverables for the project to be attained.

This section should be read in conjunction with [Section 12](#).

The resources involved are:

Human resources

Human resources include internal venue staff and team members who will be involved in the project.

It includes operational and administration staff and will, as appropriate, include full-time, part-time and casual staff as well as contractors (cleaners, security, kitchen) staff commonly used.

Some projects also require the engagement of staff on a project-based basis.

This means they work for the duration of the project – or nominated elements of it – and are then discharged.

You should seek to ‘blend’ the staff used on projects in terms of:

- Experience and inexperience – experience brings expertise. You should look to include inexperienced staff so the venue cultivates employees with experience for future use



- Ages, gender and other characteristics. This blend automatically introduces a variety of thinking into the project and demonstrates your respect of diversity in the workplace
- Representatives from as many departments and areas within the venue as realistically possible to facilitate inter-departmental cooperation and communication.

Financial resources

Financial resources are the funding to enable the project.

Funds may be obtained from:

- Money the venue has on deposit with banks or in investments
- Loans from financial institutions
- Loans from owners or joint-venture partners
- Grants from government bodies, agencies and/or authorities
- Selling old items no longer required by the venue as a result of upgrades, refurbishments or new equipment and systems
- Revenue generated as part of the project where the project entails direct selling activities which earn income.



The financial resources form the basis of the budget or budgets established for the project.

Budgets will be created for:

- Expenses/costs
- Revenue/sales – where and if applicable to the project.

Physical resources

These are the items required to support or enable required work/activities identified in the project management plan.

These may be existing items the venue already owns, or items you know you will have to:

- Purchase
- Borrow
- Access
- Lease
- Hire.

When identifying physical resources you need to identify:

- What is required
- Quantity, numbers or amount of each required
- When they are needed
- Where they can be obtained
- Cost involved in obtaining them.

Time

The importance of time has already been identified in relation to projects but it merits another discussion.

You **MUST** understand 'time' is a vital ingredient for all projects.

It is a resource in its own right.

Time is the 'fourth resource' for project management.

When negotiating with management regarding a project it is critical to include discussion about the amount of time you will be given to discharge your responsibilities.

Planning and project-related work occupies hours and hours for every project (research, forecasting, meetings with internal and external stakeholders, preparing for meetings, planning, oversight, supervision, monitoring activities, taking corrective action, report writing, evaluation).

It is also important to try to obtain as much time as possible for the project itself. The longer you have to complete the project, the better.

If you finish early you are regarded as even more impressive. Follow the standard customer service adage of 'Under-promise, and over-deliver'.

While it is not possible to negotiate time for some projects, you should always be alert to the need to try to do so.



Need to determine additional resources required

The project management plan and scope must form the basis of determining the resources required for any project but you need to be aware many project experience cost-overruns, project creep and extra requirements for clients and unexpected compliance demands from authorities.

This means there is always the potential for your project to need extra resources in addition to those identified early in the planning phase and as listed in the project management plan and as approved by management.

You need to identify this need for additional resources:

- As soon as possible – the quicker you identify these the more time you have to plan how to obtain them and to take necessary action to acquire them
- Across all resource types – you must consider the potential need for human resources, financial resources, physical resources and time
- To enable the project to achieve the objectives/deliverables – a lack of necessary resources **always** underpins **all** project failures and short-comings
- To demonstrate your effective management and oversight of the project.

Taking action to obtain additional resources

It is standard practice for you to have to discuss your request for additional resources with one or more of the following:

- Management
- Steering Committee
- Head office
- Business owner
- Client or delegating authority.

Further action which can need to be taken will depend in part on the type and quantity of resources identified as being needed.



Human resources

Action to obtain more in the way of, or from, human resources may include:

- Swapping the staff being used on the project with other staff who may be more productive
- Taking staff off other duties and allocating them to project tasks
- Engaging more staff
- Providing training
- Moving funds for staffing from a non-project budget line to a project-related labour budget line
- Monitoring the start and finish times of project staff to ensure they are working the hours they claim they are working
- Walking around the project site to provide a visible presence which allows motivates staff to apply themselves to their work
- Showing management how the *emerging* needs of the project (which were not previously identified or factored into staffing requirements) are impacting the labour budget
- Highlighting the benefits which may flow from increasing your allocation for labour. These benefits could include:
 - Better productivity
 - Quicker finish to the project
 - Increased client and/or guest and customer satisfaction
- Stressing the downsides of not providing extra staff such as:
 - Reduced customer satisfaction
 - Increased chance of penalties for non-discharge of contractual requirements
 - Negative impact on image and reputation of the venue.

Financial resources

Action to obtain more financial resources or extra benefit from limited funding may include:

- Moving money from another budget to the project budget if permitted
- Seeking additional money on the basis of new requirements not previously identified when initial funding was applied for
- Seeking reimbursement from clients for monies spent on their behalf for goods and services not agreed to as part of initial project agreements
- Ensuring deposits and progress payments are being received as expected from the client or funding body
- Reducing the quality and/or quantity of some aspects of the project to save money
- Making sure all items which can be sold to generate revenue are indeed sold and not just disposed of
- Sourcing different providers who can supply the same, or similar, goods and services at a lower price
- Using different acquisition options. Instead of buying an item you may be able to better use your limited finance by hiring or renting items
- Sharing the cost of items with other venues in the same organisation as you, or with other departments within the same venue.



Physical resources

Action to obtain more physical resources or address resource deficiency issues may include:

- Asking suppliers, providers, manufacturers to loan you items or to donate items
- Using fewer items within the project
- Using lower-quality items which will be less expensive
- Seeking contributions from your network of contacts
- Borrowing from other departments
- Doing 'contra' deals where you:
 - Swap a meal or similar at the venue in exchange for materials, goods and services from a supplier
 - Receive free product in return from advertising the product or provider in the venue
- Asking the client to contribute materials.

Time for you to manage the project

Action to obtain or 'create' more time may include:

- Explaining time already committed to the project to management to justify the claim for extra time
- Analyse your actual use of time – perhaps using a time log

- Delegating more work to other staff
- Deferring non-essential work until after the project has been completed or until a nominated stage of the project has been achieved
- Coming in to work earlier and going home later
- Working smarter using technology and accepted time management techniques to save time
- Taking time to plan your work – ‘make the plan, work the plan’.

2.6 Monitor budget in accordance with enterprise guidelines

Introduction

The budget for a project must be continually monitored.

This section discusses possible enterprise guidelines for budget monitoring and describes activities and practices which can be involved in the process.

Enterprise guidelines

Guidelines regarding the monitoring of budgets can be expected to vary between venues but, this being said, there are many similarities between what is required.

You must remember the ‘guidelines’ for monitoring budgets are more than recommendations or suggestions. They should be seen as non-negotiable requirements which are mandatory.

Anytime you fail to observe or implement these requirements management can be excused for thinking there is a problem, you have done something wrong or you have something to hide.

Budget monitoring guidelines will normally address or prescribe:

- Format of budgets used, explaining:
 - How they are laid out
 - What the columns means
 - Budget lines and codes
- Training required before you are authorised to access and monitor any venue budgets, addressing topics such as:
 - Signs and symbols used such as + and -, %
 - Budget terminology
 - Reading and understanding budgets – what they contain and what they mean
 - Identifying variances
 - Interpreting system flags or warnings
- Identification of budget types such as differentiating between the roles and contents of budgets such as:
 - Revenue budgets



- Labour budgets
- Purchases
- Overheads
- Frequency for budget monitoring which may be:
 - Daily
 - Weekly
- Supporting documents for different budget types. These are the source documents on which budgets are prepared and updated and include documents such as:
 - Receipts for revenue
 - Invoices for goods purchased
 - Staff time sheets.



Budget monitoring practices

Budget monitoring practices will involve:

Planning financial management approaches

This can require you to:

- Access budget/financial plans for the work team
- Clarify budget/financial plans with relevant personnel within the organisation to ensure that documented outcomes are achievable, accurate and comprehensible
- Negotiate any changes required to be made to budget/financial plans with relevant personnel within the organisation
- Prepare contingency plans in the event that initial plans need to be varied.

Implement financial management approaches

This can require you to:

- Disseminate relevant details of the agreed budget/financial plans to team members
- Provide support to ensure that team members can competently perform required roles associated with the management of finances
- Determine and access resources and systems to manage financial management processes within the work team.

Monitoring financial activities against budget

This can require you to:

- Check actual income and expenditure against budgets at regular intervals
- Include financial commitments in all documentation to ensure accurate monitoring
- Identify and report deviations according to organisation policy and significance of deviation
- Investigate appropriate options for more effective management of deviations
- Advise appropriate colleagues of budget status in relation to targets, within agreed timeframes.

Identifying and evaluating options for improved budget performance

This can require you to:

- Assess existing costs and resources and proactively identify areas for improvement
- Discuss desired budget outcomes with relevant colleagues
- Undertake appropriate research to investigate new approaches to budget management
- Define and communicate clearly the benefits and disadvantages of new approaches
- Take account of impacts on customer service levels and colleagues in developing new approaches
- Present recommendations for budget management clearly and logically to the appropriate person or department.

Completing required financial and statistical reports

This can require you to:

- Complete all required financial and statistical reports accurately and within designated timelines
- Produce clear and concise information to enable informed decision making
- Forward reports promptly to the appropriate persons or departments.

2.7 Provide regular reports on project progress to all appropriate colleagues/customers

Introduction

It is a standard requirement that all projects are subject to some form of reporting requirements.

This section identifies background information on reports and the role of these reports.

This section must be read in conjunction with Section 3.6.

Types of reports

Reports may be provided:

- Verbally
- In written form.

You may be required to make a formal presentation of your report during which you can be asked questions by those in attendance (the stakeholders for the project), and expected to explain irregularities and shortcomings as well as justify decisions made and action taken.



Timing of reports

Reports may be required:

- When the project commences – an Inception report
- Throughout the project – known as ‘Progress reports’
- On conclusion of the project – called a ‘Final report’.

The timing of these reports should be negotiated with stakeholders as part of the planning process so you know well in advance what your reporting obligations are.

Note that submitting required reports on the dates they are due is as important as completing the project in accordance with the timelines for the project.

Involving others

You are advised to seek assistance from all relevant persons as part of your activities in preparing and writing the required reports.

This means involving and seeking input and comment from:

- The client
- Your project team members
- The Steering Committee
- External providers and contractors
- Any other body or organisation who have had significant impact on the project or who can be expected to have significant impact.



The role of project reports

Project reports:

- Enable communication with stakeholders regarding progress of the project including identification of issues arising, delays and their cause, and foreseeable problems. In this way reports look backwards at what has happened, and also looks forward to what may be expected to happen
- Help you demonstrate openness, due diligence, accountability, honesty, transparency and general management practices applied to the project
- May be a term of the contract for a project that exists with, for example, a funding agency or authority
- Provide hard copy information for future reference. The reports should be filed and form part of a growing body of information that can be referred to learn lessons
- Allow another opportunity for you to talk to the stakeholders to express fears about the project, convey impressions about providers, identify concerns and give a general appraisal of the project across all relevant topics and issues.

Content of the reports

There is rarely a detailed list of what the project reports are required to cover. The project management plan tends to simply state a report is due on a given date and then leave the contents of the report to your discretion.

This said, the project plan must be the basis for all reports. The fundamental requirement is that all stated KPIs, milestones and stages contained in the project management plan must be addressed.

Generically speaking this requires your report to address:

- The extent to which required outcomes as identified in the project plan have actually been achieved and, as applicable, the extent to which this area is behind or in front of the timelines. This is a central part of any report and focuses on the extent to which deliverables are being achieved. Comments in this part of the report should also address:
 - Quality and quality-related issues
 - Use of physical resources
- Budget – identifying the money spent and percentage of allocated funds which have been spent. A copy of supporting documentation may be included as part of budget coverage
- Input and feedback from stakeholders regarding the project such as:
 - Identification of issues
 - Complaints
 - Compliments received regarding the project
 - Issues suppliers or contractors believe have the potential to impact on deliverables
- Issues arising and issues of concern to you.



2.8 Complete the project within agreed time lines

Introduction

A key requirement for any project is to complete the project as intended within the required timelines.

This section presents a range of standard procedures to optimise timely completion of projects.

Possible actions to optimise timely project delivery

The following is a generic list of activities which you may be able, or need to, apply during a project in order to complete it on time.

Obviously the actions you elect to take will depend on:

- The individual circumstances of the specific project you are managing

- The problems and issues which have arisen
- The stage at which the problem or issue has been identified.

Possible actions – from start to finish of a project – which will help complete the project on time include:

- Conduct appropriate start-up activities making sure all those engaged with the project know exactly what their roles and responsibilities are, and what your expectations are. The key is that final project deliverables are based on initial understanding. You have to put in place this understanding at the start of the project. You cannot wait until the end of the project to do it, and you cannot wait until there is a problem before this is addressed. You have to start the project the way you intend it to be maintained
- Schedule the provision of all identified or necessary resources:
 - Staff, contractors, sub-contractors. A primary task of any PM is coordination of resources
 - Materials, products, systems, plant and equipment
 - Funds, cash, credit
 - Inspections and approvals to facilitate further work and the next tasks
 - Manage the procurement of resources to ensure required materials and other resources are available when needed
 - Lack of resources when needed is one of the biggest causes of delays to projects
 - Check, validate and/or authorise all project-related documentation especially anything relating to purchases/expenditure, certification of work completed and variations to contracts or plans. Making it a priority to be actively involved in these decisions and activities is the key to knowing how the project is progressing and to quickly identifying potential problems, delays and cost over-runs
- Monitor progress of the project against the project management plan on a regular or daily basis to enable the earliest identification of problems
- Do more yourself. The reality of many projects is you will have to do a substantial amount of the work yourself. When things are running behind schedule this means you have to do even more
- Ask others to do more. Explain the 'behind schedule situation' and its implications and encourage and motivate others to do more, work harder or be more productive
- Adjust plans as required. Rarely does any project reach a successful conclusion without the need for original plans to be altered. Your ability to smoothly accommodate the need for change in this regard will be a major indicator of your ability as a PM. You will be expected to make small changes on the spot and unilaterally. Larger changes will need to be referred to the management, stakeholders or the Steering Committee for their input and approval



- Conduct regular meetings with stakeholders to discuss progress, enable their input, resolve issues, and maintain satisfactory relationships (which can prove beneficial when you have to ask for extra time or resources, or explain why the project is running behind schedule)
- Report on the project as required by the project plan. This can help alert others to the possibility they need to assist with ensuring you can bring the project in on time. It is also possible that those who receive and read your reports can provide advice about what to do to retrieve the situation
- If you know you have to report, this can also serve as a motivator for you
- Maintain the project team. This can mean you need to address and resolve team-based issues, rotate staff through the project team, match staff to required competencies and abilities, maintain team harmony and support team dynamics
- Negotiate an extension of the deadline. This is arguably one of the most common responses to problems with a project but is not an option for projects such as functions and events. The potential for time overruns on a project is extremely high especially when the venue is relying on external providers and contractors to supply products and services. Given the enormous potential for events to impact on a project (such as supply problems further down the supply chain, weather, staffing issues, unforeseen problems, transport), this should come as no surprise. It is a major reason why those involved in developing contracts for projects will negotiate the longest possible time for completion
- Change roles and responsibilities within project team members to address interpersonal conflict situations, to address a situation where the existing team does not have the necessary skills and expertise to achieve the project deliverables
- Outsource aspects of the project. There can be times when you believe the venue can deliver on certain outcomes or deliverables, only to find in reality this is impossible. Perhaps staff are not skilled enough, perhaps they are too busy, or perhaps they have no real commitment to what needs to be done. Regardless of the reason, effective project management at times can mean engaging the professional services of an external third party to replace what you believed could be handled in-house. It is important for you to understand that doing this is not an indication of your incompetence. Rather it is testimony to your ability to recognise a problem and take appropriate action in response. If you had simply persevered with a situation which was obviously not working, then that would be an indicator of your incompetence
- Reduce costs on materials or physical resources so more money is available for labour to complete the project. Limited options for reducing costs include:
 - Extending timelines. Suppliers or contractors may be prepared to reduce costs if they have longer to deliver
 - Lowering quality standards/criteria. This can mean accepting a lower quality in exchange for lower prices
 - Negotiating discounts for prompt payment
 - Sourcing alternative suppliers
 - Revising project deliverables to enable reductions in expenditure

Always talk with suppliers and contractors to explain the need to cut costs and hope they are prepared to accommodate (at least to some extent) your requirements.

It is a fact of life that sometimes simply talking to a supplier can result in a 5% reduction to quoted prices.

- Seek more money for labour from management or seek approval to make a budget line transfer to obtain extra labour funds
- Research and apply more efficient methods for completing project tasks. There can often be a need to do this where:
 - Safety and security is not an issue
 - Unexpected problems have emerged
 - Authorities have intervened and requested changes
 - New or different standards, compliance requirements have emerged.

Communication is the key

Whenever you are faced with a situation where remedial or other action needs to be taken in relation to a project, effective communication is vital:

- Communicate early. Communicate as soon as a potential risk or issue has been identified: never wait
- Communicate fully – be honest, open and tell the complete story about the actual/potential risk
- Involve all stakeholders – do not be selective: collaboration and consultation are vital.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

NOTE: This Work Project can follow-on from Work Project 1.1 and may provide the basis for Work Project 3.1.

2.1 To meet the requirements for this Work Project you are required to identify and describe a small project (which may be an actual project or a simulated mock project) and provide details regarding administering and monitoring by answering the following questions:

- What would you do to implement and monitor the project?
 - Who would you involve in administering and monitoring activities for the project?
 - What support and assistance do you think you would need to provide to project team staff?
 - How would you build trust and respect with your project team staff and external providers and contractors?
 - What activities would you undertake to assess and review progress of the project against project goals and the project management plan?
 - How might you identify the need for additional resources as the project progresses?
 - What would you do to monitor the project budget?
 - What reports might you provide on the progress of the project and what topics would these reports address?
 - What generic actions could you take to ensure the project is completed by the required date?
-

Summary

Administer and monitor project

When administering and monitoring projects:

- Make sure all preparation and planning has been completed
- Verify you have authorisation to proceed
- Know what the project management plan contains
- Work the plan
- Use a project notebook
- Manage quality
- Provide support and assistance to project team members as required
- Build trust and respect with all stakeholders
- Assess and review the project at regular points
- Be alert to the potential for the project to require additional human, physical and financial resources as well as time
- Respond promptly to identified need for extra resources
- Monitor the budget and financial activities for the project
- Report in accordance with the requirements of the project management plan
- Take necessary action to complete the project on time.

Element 3: Evaluate project

3.1 Assess project at specified stages, using agreed evaluation methods

Introduction

All projects must be assessed.

This section identifies when projects may be assessed and presents again possible evaluation methods which may be applied.

Frequency of assessing the project

The project should be assessed:

- On an ongoing basis – throughout the life of the project
- At the end of the project – when the project has been completed: see [Section 3.2](#).

Personal and project team options

The project should be assessed by:

- You – on your own. You need to identify time for reviewing the project and comparing progress to the project plan. This may need to be done on a daily basis. It should be done at least weekly. You need to develop your own perspective on the progress of the project
- By the project team and relevant stakeholders. These people can:
 - Make you aware of new factors you were previously unaware of
 - Confirm your own impression of the progress of the project.



Opportunities for ongoing assessments

This form of project assessment may take many forms and **does not** always require structured or formal evaluation.

Possible opportunities for these ongoing assessments may be:

- Daily briefing sessions with the project team undertaken at the start of each day. These sessions are ideal times for a group evaluation of the project and its progress. Certainly 'project review, evaluation and assessment' should be a standing topic at all staff meetings and briefings for those involved with the project

- Daily debriefing sessions which is an ideal time to discuss progress or problems identified during the day or shift
- Scheduled project team meetings
- Specially-convened project review and evaluation meetings
- When complaints about the project are received
- When significant problems with the project arise
- When key providers or contractors indicate they are unable to perform their project obligations as agreed
- When the client requests changes to the agreed requirements for the project.



Evaluation options

The remainder of this section is duplicated from [Section 1.7](#).

All projects should be evaluated.

The extent and degree of the evaluation should reflect the size of the project: small projects should have smaller evaluations than major projects.

For large projects a formal 'evaluation plan' may be produced but this is not usual for small projects.

Evaluating a project means analysing and assessing the outcome of the project measured against identified criteria established before the project commences.

Evaluation options for small projects may require one or more of the following alternatives to be used.

Evaluation options

Effective evaluation techniques for small projects include:

- Conducting surveys. This involves talking to 'relevant persons' about the implementation and outcomes of the project. Surveys should:
 - Be structured so all those surveyed are asked to respond to the same questions
 - Allow free space for respondents to add issues of their choiceSurveys may be conducted one on one, or feature the use of group surveys or focus groups.
- Applying questionnaires to nominated people. These may be paper-based or online questions posed to solicit input and feedback about the project
- Workplace observation relating to project implementation and note-taking to provide a basis for later analysis
- Engaging in pilots for aspects of the project. This features implementation of actual workplace trials of project elements to determine effectiveness, and reactions and responses from those who are impacted (such as clients, customers and staff) as well as funding bodies and delegating authorities

- Capturing and analysing quantitative workplace data and qualitative data to identify changes which have flowed as a result of the project so these can be compared against projections. Note that 'baseline data' must first be established for every aspect of data which is to be analysed. Quantitative data relates to 'figures and numbers' (known also as 'hard data') such as sales, profit, percentages, ratios, units and other information which can be presented in statistical form. Qualitative data (known also as 'soft data') refers to how people feel about the project, why they think what they think about the project and issues relating to how the project has impacted them.

3.2 Take account of agreed goals and priorities when carrying out a project evaluation

Introduction

There must be a specific focus for all project evaluations.

This section presents basic necessities for a final project evaluation, explains why the review should be undertaken, identifies topics covered in the evaluation and lists suggestions for organising a project review.

Basics of project assessment and reviews

For the evaluation of a project the following applies:

- Assessments and reviews of the project must occur during the project – see [Section 2.4](#)
- The project review at the end of the project is sometimes referred to as a *post mortem*
- The end of project assessment and review (evaluation) phase for a project must reflect/implement the evaluation methods identified in the planning process – see [Section 1.7](#)
- The timeline for assessment and review of the project as stated in the project management plan must be complied with.



Why assess and review projects when they have been completed?

The main reasons for assessing and reviewing projects are to:

- Confirm project status. You need to verify the projected is truly completed and signed off, or whether there are still ongoing issues which still need to be resolved
- Learn lessons which could be used for future projects so the *next* project does not repeat any mistakes of *this* project
- Review activities, issues and problems relating to the project to identify what these were and, more importantly, *why* they occurred
- Learn about how the venue and staff performed. Project reviews can provide useful insight into venue culture, general staff morale and individual staff performance
- Discharge 'due diligence' requirements

- Determine follow-up action which may need to be taken to put the finishing touches to a project and/or take corrective action to fix project-related problems
- Provide useful, relevant and sought-after feedback to venue staff and teams who were involved in the project. Commonly those involved in a project also want to know how they performed
- Identify actions taken by anyone in the project that functioned to impede the project such as, for example, instances where failure to complete a task caused the delay of another task, or sub-standard performance by a contractor
- Provide detail and information to be used in formal reporting requirements for the project. Reports can use information obtained as part of the review process
- Formally finalise the project management plan by fulfilling what is usually the last stage listed in the plan ('Project evaluation/review').

What does the final assessment and review cover?

This end of project assessment and review is an evaluation of how the project was planned, implemented, monitored and overseen.

Anything related to the project is ground for review.

The project review should consider (this list is only indicative and not intended to be exhaustive):

- Funding levels and sources:
 - Were sufficient funds allocated to enable achievement of project deliverables?
 - Were the best funding sources accessed for the project?
- Resource use and allocation:
 - Were appropriate, sufficient, compliant resources used and/or made available?
 - Were the resources made available actually suitable for the project?
- Timing issues:
 - Was there sufficient lead time to enable appropriate planning?
 - Did staff used in the project have enough time to do their project-related work as well as other 'normal' venue duties?
- Personnel involved in the project:
 - Did you use 'the right staff' from within the business, and from outside agencies and businesses?
 - Did you have sufficient staff involved?
- Role of stakeholders in the project:
 - Did they actually perform within the project as they promised they would?
 - What advantages and disadvantages were there in having these stakeholders involved?
 - Who would you want or not want next time, and why?



- Problems encountered:
 - What unforeseen issues and problems occurred during the project?
 - How were they addressed and could they have been addressed more effectively?
 - How can these situations be avoided next time?
- Evaluation of the project against the project management plan. All elements of the project plan should be subject to review:
 - How effective was the plan? Was the project plan sufficiently detailed, instructive and focussed?
 - Did the project management plan provide sufficient guidance for the project?
 - To what extent were the deliverables, objectives, outcomes and other items in the project plan actually achieved?
 - If there was a discrepancy between 'actual' and 'expected' outcomes, are these acceptable?
 - Why did they occur?
 - Did those nominated in the project plan discharge their allocated responsibilities?
 - Were designated timelines adhered to? If not, why not?
 - Were all compliance requirements achieved?
 - How effective, with the benefit of hindsight, was the risk management for the project?
 - Were all actual risks identified and effectively managed?
- Budget. There is always a need to consider 'budget' in any project review:
 - Were there cost over-runs?
 - If so, to what extent and why?
 - Could the cost blow-outs have been predicted? Avoided?
 - Did the project make the most effective and efficient use of the funds (and other resources) provided for it?
- Lessons learned – see [Section 3.5](#).



Useful points to note when organising a project review

The following points will help you undertake an effective project assessment:

- Review the project against the criteria, milestones, KPI and other relevant criteria you said you were going to review it against
- Be inclusive and make sure all necessary stakeholders are included in the review process or have an opportunity to make input and comment

- Schedule the review meetings and give those who are to attend plenty of notice about the time, date, location and expected duration of meetings. It is best to schedule this meetings soon after the project has been completed so things are still fresh in people's minds
- Forward any relevant documents to these people so they can pre-read them and attend the meetings informed about what is to be discussed
- Establish standard documents and filing protocols to facilitate the review and all subsequent reviews. Try to avoid a situation where documents need to be developed again every time a project review occurs
- Make sure all internal staff involved in the review are aware the process is not a witch hunt. The review must be characterised by honest and comprehensive input from participants so it is important they realise the focus is on gathering information rather than allocating blame
- Take the review of the project as seriously as you did the planning and execution of the project. The review is an integral part of the project, not just an after-thought
- Circulate the 'findings' of the review to stakeholders as identified by management/the Steering Committee.



3.3 Involve project team members, appropriate colleagues and customers in the project evaluation

Introduction

The review of a project will always be a joint process involving representatives from stakeholders previously involved in planning and implementing and executing the project and/or those who have received communication regarding the project.

This section discusses the involvement of others in the evaluation process at the end of a project.

Who should be involved in the review?

Opinion is split about who should be involved in the final project review.

Some believe the review needs to be all-encompassing and must involve *all* stakeholders, as identified in the planning stage.

They believe this best addresses transparency and accountability requirements and is essential for a comprehensive review.

Being open and inclusive allows more input (views, thinking and opinions) to be captured but is more expensive and time consuming.

Others believe there is a need to be *selective* in terms of who is invited to participate, and to only include those from within the venue who were actually involved with the project plus, where applicable, the client and/or delegating authority or person paying the bill for a project or function.

Where the review is extensive, it is common to have several 'review meetings'. Some are for 'external' stakeholders while others are restricted just to staff or team members and management.

The decision about who to include may be yours, or it may be one made by management, the Steering Committee, the funding body or the delegating authority.

Suggestions for inclusion of people in the review process

The type and scope of the project will be major factors helping to determine who should be involved in the review process.

To obtain useful feedback about the project you may consider including the list below. Remember different individuals may attend different meetings so confidences can be maintained, and participants are encouraged to speak freely and honestly (many people will be reserved in their input when talking in front of 'others' from outside the venue):

- Management
- Steering Committee
- Project team members where a team (or similar) was developed to manage and/or discharge the requirements of the project
- Representatives from external professional organisations/bodies – accountants, legal advisers, government agencies
- Staff/team members involved in implementing and executing the project
- Staff/team members on whom the project impacted but who were not involved in its execution
- Internal venue 'support staff' such as bookkeepers, store personnel, anyone whose work was associated with assisting in the organisation and execution of the project
- Customers and guests on whom the execution of the project impacted and on whom any 'finished product' (new facilities, revised menus, refurbished rooms) impacts.



Tips on involving people in the review process

The following are useful tips which have proved effective:

- Try to minimise the time people are expected to commit to the review process – do not drag it out
- Time the meetings at suitable times to optimise the chance of people attending.

Staff should be paid to attend or required to attend during work hours

- Actively encourage participation. Speak to those you want to attend and encourage them to turn up and take part. Urge them to actively participate
- Reward people for attending by, for example:
 - Verbally thanking them for their time and input
 - Providing refreshments or a meal as part of the review meeting
 - Sending participants a 'letter of thanks'

- Encourage people to provide honest input from their perspective. Stress the review process is not intended to rubber-stamp what has occurred
- Ask questions to motivate them to give feedback. Do not rely on participants to 'give' information
- Structure the review session. Take time to plan it so it has:
 - An Introduction explaining what the session will cover
 - A Main Body. This is the structured set of questions to be asked to solicit feedback. You will need to have identified the areas you want feedback on, and phrased the questions so they are not 'loaded' or biased
 - A 'Question and Answer' session to enable input on issues not addressed by the structured questions
 - A Conclusion which could include thanks to those who attended; an indication of future projects; explanation of action to be taken on the basis of feedback received.



3.4 Incorporate evaluation results into ongoing project management

Introduction

The outcomes or findings of project evaluation need to be factored in to ongoing project management and future project management.

This section discusses incorporation of evaluation results into ongoing project management.

This section should be read in conjunction with the following section and [Sections 2.4 and 2.8](#).

Processes and products

The evaluation process must consider:

- Processes – that is, the actions taken to achieve the outcomes or project deliverables
- Products – the end result of action taken: the outcomes or project deliverables as they exist at the point the evaluation is being undertaken.

The findings of the evaluation against these two criteria are what must be factored in to ongoing project management.

Factoring in the evaluation results

The action to take to factor in evaluation results must:

- Reflect actual evidence gathered as part of the evaluation process as opposed to reflecting unsubstantiated beliefs and assumptions
- Address both 'processes' and 'products'
- Fall within the parameters, obligations and restrictions for the project.

Practical considerations

In practical terms you:

- Rarely need to make significant changes to your project management plan. Most changes which are identified as being necessary on the basis of ongoing evaluation throughout the life of a project are relatively small. They are more a 'fine tuning' of the plan rather than a rewriting of the plan
- May need to source additional resources to enable completion of the project as planned (see Section 2.6)
- May need to adjust:
 - Staffing such as the hours for staff, the mix of workers and the number of personnel
 - Completion time for nominated tasks, Stages and the final project
 - Alter other aspects of the plan such as:
 - Resources
 - Responsibilities
 - Providers
 - KPIs
 - Elements of identified Stages
 - Milestones
 - Quality criteria
- Should communicate to stakeholders:
 - The findings of the progressive evaluations advising them of all relevant points, the positive and the negative
 - Explaining reasons for required changes and explaining the causal factors
- Will need to seek approval for changes you intend making for the original project management plan
- Must distribute the revised project management plan to those who received a copy of the original project plan and there may be a need to hold a meeting to explain the revised plan.



3.5 Share information from project evaluation with appropriate colleagues and incorporate information into future planning

Introduction

It is not sufficient to simply 'discuss' the project when reviewing it. A primary objective of the review should be the documentation and retention of information which can be beneficially used by the venue when future projects are undertaken.

This section discusses documenting the lessons learned from project evaluation, incorporation of these lessons into future planning and ways to share the findings of project evaluations.

Documenting lessons learned

The formal assessment/review and evaluation process must be the basis for formulating the lessons learned from the project.

Any lessons learned must be based on 'evidence' as opposed to subjective impressions.

Documenting lessons learned involves:

- Writing down the lessons learned describing the situation that gave rise to the lesson, and what the exact nature of the lesson is (that is, how subsequent projects should take into account the lessons learned)
- Attaching supporting or accompanying documentation to the lesson such as (as appropriate) written feedback from stakeholders, sections of legislation, copies of quotes, invoices, product samples or letters of complaint
- Including basic data – name of the project, details of project team and management team, dates, and base project documents used in the project (such as the project management plan)
- Communicating the lessons learned – see below and next section
- Filing the documents and data. Filing will/should occur in a physical, paper-based format and electronic format. Attention must be paid to ensuring 'relevant others' know where this information and/or documents are physically located so they can access it when required. Standard filing protocols should apply to ensure:
 - Security
 - Protect confidentiality
 - Track and record use of the documents.



Commonly, lessons learned are not 'generally' distributed. That is, they are not usually communicated to external stakeholders or 'the public'.

Incorporating lessons learned into future projects

To help optimise inclusion of lessons learned from past projects into future projects the following can be applied:

- Circulate lessons learned to other PMs within the venue and meet to discuss them
- Integrate lessons learned into venue training for project managers
- Revise venue policies and procedures to include the lessons learned ensuring version control protocols are implemented to maintain currency of documents
- Hold special staff-management meetings to discuss the lessons learned
- Provide SOP for project managers which makes it mandatory for them to:
 - Talk to previous PMs before they start planning a project
 - Read/review evaluations ('lessons learned') from previous projects.

Sharing information from the project evaluation

The following are acceptable ways of sharing information on the outcomes of the project evaluation you have undertaken:

- Make a verbal report to management – this may be all that is required in many cases for a small project
- Make a verbal report to nominated stakeholders – internal and/or external
- Do a formal presentation on the findings which will entail a need to:
 - Verbally present the final evaluation
 - Explain aspects of it
 - Defend decisions made
 - Justify expenditure
 - Confirm or clarify points arising
 - Provide supporting or evidentiary documentation
- Complete and return an Evaluation Sheet as and if required by a client, funding body or delegating authority
- Circulate a formal report on the project – see next section
- Meet with key internal figures to discuss the findings. These would include:
 - Managers and supervisors
 - Other people with project management responsibilities
 - Trainers and training staff – so they integrate findings into in-house trainers
 - Those with responsibility for preparing and updating venue policies and procedures – so findings can be formalized into internal SOPs.



3.6 Report on project

Introduction

All projects will require you to complete some form of report when the project has been finalised.

A written report is often required.

This section discusses possible reporting requirements at the conclusion of a project.

Written report format

If there is a standard format for completing project reports at your venue you should use this format.

If there is no standard format, discuss with management or the client what the format and content should be.

If you have to prepare a report for an external body, ask them for a copy of a report from a previous report and use this as your basis.

The following points are commonly addressed in relation to contents of Project Reports:

- Name and title of the Report – ‘Review and upgrade of in-house training’
- Name of the venue
- Name of the Project
- Name of the person or persons who prepared the Report
- The date and period to which the Report applies
- Identification of nature of the Report, for example, ‘First Interim Report’, ‘Final Report’
- Executive Summary – a single page synthesising the content of the report
- KPIs, milestones and stages the project management plan identified as being applicable in relation to *this* Report
- Actual progress matched against the stated criteria identifying reasons for above and/or below expected outcomes
- Budget
- Your observations as PM. Your Project Notebook should be used to help write this section of the Report. You may raise topics such as:
 - Unexpected delays
 - Problems with suppliers and contractors and/or venue-based project staff
 - Instances of unacceptable work which has had to be redone
 - Unexpected impacts of the project on customers or normal venue operation
 - Emerging safety issues and hazards
 - Suggestions and recommendations for action to address identified issues, time lags, sub-standard quality issues and others issues raised in the Report.



Distributing project reports

All Project Reports should be regarded as commercial-in-confidence.

They must only be released to the people, bodies or agencies identified on a ‘Distribution List’ approved by management.

Common ways to forward reports are:

- By hand – distributing appropriately-bound hard copies. Distributing by hand also allows you to talk to the report when you hand it over

- Electronically – via email. Take care to double-check the correct email address is being used. It is not standard practice to send reports by facsimile
- Using the intranet
- Using the postal system or couriers to deliver hard copies to external stakeholders.

Note

Where there are regular face to face meetings with stakeholders who receive a copy of Project Reports, there should be no surprises in the Report.

Any problems with the progress of the project should have been mentioned at meetings with these people meaning readers of the Report are already aware of them.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

NOTE: This Work Project can follow-on from Work Project 1.1 and 2.1.

3.1 To meet the requirements for this Work Project you are required to identify and describe a small project (which may be an actual project or a simulated mock project) and provide details regarding project evaluation by answering the following questions:

- How would you assess the project at specified stages throughout its life?
 - Who would be involved in this assessment?
 - Why would they be involved?
 - How do the agreed goals and the project management plan impact on project evaluation?
 - Why is there a need to factor in project evaluation results into ongoing project management?
 - How could you share the results of project evaluation findings with stakeholders?
 - What action could you take to ensure the findings of the project evaluation are incorporated into future projects?
 - What reporting would you undertake for the project?
 - What would the report cover look like and who would it be distributed to?
-

Summary

Evaluate project

When evaluating projects:

- Ensure you allocate time for scheduled assessments
- Involve relevant internal and external stakeholders
- Schedule meetings for formal evaluations and assessments
- Address 'process' and 'product' issues
- Assess actual project performance against planned performance
- Use the project management plan as the basis for evaluation, assessment and review
- Adjust the project plan on the basis of assessment/review findings
- Incorporate evaluation results into ongoing project management for the project being assessed
- Obtain necessary authorisations for project plan revisions and amendments
- Circulate copies of the revised project plan
- Share the findings of the evaluation
- Factor in lessons learned into future project management activities
- Prepare and distribute a report on the project.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organized. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognize and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Note: all Recommended Reading is sourced from 'Trove: National Library of Australia' at <http://trove.nla.gov.au/>.

Barkley, Bruce 2004; *Project risk management*; McGraw-Hill, New York

Burke, Rory 2007; *Introduction to project management: one small step for the project manager*; Burke Pub, [U.K.]

Cappels, Thomas M & Books24x7, Inc 2004; *Financially focused project management*; J. Ross Pub, Boca Raton, Fla

Diab, Philip R 2011; *Sidestep complexity: project management for small- and medium-sized organizations*; Project Management Institute, Newtown Square, PA

Kemp, Sid & Entrepreneur (Santa Monica, Calif.) 2005; *Ultimate guide to project management for small business: get it done right!*; Entrepreneur Press, [Santa Monica, Calif.]

Lock, Dennis 2007; *Project management*; 9th ed, Ashgate, Burlington, VT

Phillips, Joseph 2012; *Project management for small business: a streamlined approach from planning to completion*; American Management Association, New York

Trainee evaluation sheet

Manage and implement small projects

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organized.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Manage and implement small projects

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Plan project			
1.1	Develop the objectives and scope of the project in consultation with appropriate colleagues and customers	☐	☐
1.2	Determine and develop a resource strategy for the project	☐	☐
1.3	Evaluate the financial viability of the project through analysis of key factors	☐	☐
1.4	Plan and create an administrative structure for the project	☐	☐
1.5	Allocate project responsibilities in agreement with others, and clearly communicate responsibilities to all involved	☐	☐
1.6	Plan internal and external communications, and public relations and marketing strategies together with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐
1.7	Reach agreement on suitable project evaluation methods	☐	☐
1.8	Develop an overall project management plan and communicate plan to appropriate colleagues	☐	☐
1.9	Identify key project milestones and communicate these to persons involved	☐	☐
Element 2: Administer and monitor project			
2.1	Implement and monitor project in conjunction with project team members	☐	☐
2.2	Provide support and assistance to team members, as required	☐	☐
2.3	Build trust and respect within the project team	☐	☐
2.4	Assess and review progress against project goals and in consultation with project team members	☐	☐
2.5	Determine the need for additional project resources and take action accordingly	☐	☐
2.6	Monitor budget in accordance with enterprise guidelines	☐	☐
2.7	Provide regular reports on project progress to all appropriate colleagues/customers	☐	☐
2.8	Complete the project within agreed time lines	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 3: Evaluate project			
3.1	Assess project at specified stages, using agreed evaluation methods	☐	☐
3.2	Take account of agreed goals and priorities when carrying out a project evaluation	☐	☐
3.3	Involve project team members, appropriate colleagues and customers in the project evaluation	☐	☐
3.4	Incorporate evaluation results into ongoing project management	☐	☐
3.5	Share information from project evaluation with appropriate colleagues and incorporate information into future planning	☐	☐
3.6	Report on project	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

